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Virginia Board of Education, Work Session, Wednesday, October 18, 2023

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- Official meeting video (VDOE, YouTube): https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=GZ8VUbgJJwo
- Board of Education meetings, agendas and minutes (VDOE): https://www.doe.virginia.gov/state-board-data-funding/virginia-board-of-education

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Speech-to-text: whisper.cpp, model large-v3-turbo. Produced 2026-10-23. Each paragraph starts with its time [HH:MM:SS] in the meeting video.

[00:15:58] I would like to call our meeting to order this morning, and it is 9:05 a.m., and I'll note that I have approved the remote participation of Dr. Allen Siebert under the board's bylaws and 2.2-3708.3 B.3 of the Code of Virginia because his principal residence is more than 60 miles away from our meeting location today.

[00:16:25] And with that being said, we will go ahead and I'll take a motion to go into closed session. Move. You want to read us into closed session, please? I move that the Virginia Board of Education convene in a closed meeting for the following purposes, discussion or consideration by the Board of Education of information relating to the denial, suspension, or revocation of teacher licenses subject to the exclusion in subdivision 11 of section 2.2-1.

[00:16:58] 3705.2 pursuant to section 2.2-3711A40 of the code of Virginia and consultation with counsel regarding specific legal matters requiring the provision of legal advice pursuant to Virginia code section 2.2-3711A8 of the code of Virginia and the legal counsel to the Virginia board of education and staff whose presence will aid in the board's consideration of this matter participate in the closed meeting can i get a second on that second thing all those in favor

[00:17:40] and we are in closed session now we convened today we convened today in a closed meeting

[03:32:04] pursuant to a reported vote on the motion above and in accordance with the freedom of information act section 2.2-3712 of the code of virginia requires that the board certify that to the best of each member's knowledge only public business matters lawfully exempt from opening open meeting requirements under this chapter and only such public business matters as were identified in the motion by which the closed meeting was convened were heard discussed or considered any member who believes there was a departure from these requirements she'll so state prior to the vote indicating the substance of the departure that in his or her judgment has taken

[03:32:43] place the statement of the departure will be recorded in the minutes i still move miss kilgore hi miss holton hi dr siebert mr hanson miss ashton hi dr northern hi mr sturdifan hi mr rotherham hi chair votes aye okay um in the in the in case number one the chair will entertain a motion to

[03:33:15] issue a license to the applicant. So moved. Second. Ms. Kilgore. Aye. Ms. Fulton. Aye. Dr. Siebert. Aye. Mr. Hansen. Aye. Ms. Ashton. Aye. Dr. Northern. Aye. Mr. Sturdifant. Aye. Mr. Rotherham. Aye. And chair votes aye. In case number two, the chair will entertain a motion to suspend the license of Stephen Patrick Campbell for two years with reinstatement contingent

[03:33:49] upon appearing before the board. I move. Second. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Mr. Sturdifant? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. And chair votes aye. In case number three, the chair will entertain a motion to deny a license to William Arthur Sorenson. Ms. Kilgore? No. Ms. Holton? No.

[03:34:24] Dr. Siebert. Aye. Mr. Hansen. No. Ms. Ashton. Aye. Dr. Northern. No. Mr. Sturdifant. Aye. Mr. Rotherham. Aye. And chair votes aye. Okay. So that was five. Five ayes, four no's. Okay. In case number four, the chair will entertain a motion to deny a license to Eman Taysir Salem.

[03:35:07] Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Mr. Sturdifant? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. And Chair Boats? Aye. Okay.

[03:35:27] In case number five, the chair will entertain a motion to issue a provisional license to the applicant based upon completion of licensure requirements and employment by a public school division or accredited private school. Second. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye.

[03:35:56] Mr. Hansen? Aye. Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Mr. Sturdefin? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? Aye. And chair votes aye. Okay. In case number six, the chair will entertain a motion to issue a license to the applicant. So moved. Ms. Kilgore? Aye. Ms. Holton? Aye. Dr. Siebert? Aye. Mr. Hanson? Aye.

[03:36:25] Ms. Ashton? Aye. Dr. Northern? Aye. Mr. Sturdifant? Aye. Mr. Rotherham? No. And chair votes no. So that is six to three. So the motion carries. Okay. Thank you all for your participation in our executive session this morning. We will pause here and take a lunch break and come back

[03:37:01] at 1.15. Okay. Good afternoon. Welcome to the Board of Education's work session. I will note

[04:32:51] once again that I've approved the remote participation of Dr. Alan Siebert under the Board's bylaws and 2.2-3708.3 of the Code of Virginia because this principal residence is more than 60 miles away from our meeting location. We have an exciting agenda today, lots to cover, and I'm excited for what we have already done, what we're going to do, and the things that we're going to hear today.

[04:33:17] So I'm really I'm really excited to hear the direction that these conversations are going to take us today. But before we get moving on that, I want to make sure a little housekeeping issue here at the

board's meeting in August.

[04:33:34] If you all will remember during the discussion section of the agenda, I had asked that we form some new committees in order to facilitate some work of the board. And those committees have not yet met. And because of the fact that we have let the department under the guidance of Dr. Coons do research on this work for us. And so since those committees were formed publicly, I would like to dissolve them publicly.

[04:34:02] And so that is the purpose of my comments here as we move into item A. And I do, as we move into item A, expect that this conversation on this particular item may take us some time.

[04:34:19] This is one of the board's constitutional responsibilities. As you all know, this board prescribes the SOQ and the General Assembly revises what the board, what this board prescribes and determines the funding there.

[04:34:34] So I think we ought to keep that in mind as we move through this discussion that the board prescribes and the general, the different responsibilities of us as a board and the responsibilities of the General Assembly. So the board's SOQ prescriptions, along with our work in the standards of accreditation and standards of learning, are really at the heart of this general supervision of the public school system that is referenced in the Constitution.

[04:35:06] Most of you know that I, having been in the classroom, and I can tell you that while these conversations will get technical about law and funding, they have an immense impact on our schools and what teachers across the Commonwealth, administrators, support staff do every single day in our schools.

[04:35:30] And so with that, I would like to ask Dr. Raley and Dr. Myers to come up and provide our presentation for item A this afternoon. So thank you, gentlemen. Thank you. Get the presentation up and go ahead and get started. I know that after lunch, hopefully we can keep you awake a little bit.

[04:35:57] You don't have a song and dance, but hopefully have some really good information to share with you today. While the presentation is coming up, our goal for the next little bit is to provide you with really three things. Number one is providing the board with some background related to this really important topic. And certainly the public has the benefit of receiving that background at the same time, because as Ms. Creasy said, there's significant references in the Constitution of Virginia and the Code of Virginia specifically related to the board's responsibility on the standards of quality. I want to transition that to Dr. Myers, who's going to share some of the

[04:36:33] survey results from our superintendents who expressed their perspectives on this important topic and compare where we were in 2019 and some of the data from 2023, which is recent, and then I'll finish up with some of the next steps for the board to consider moving forward.

[04:36:50] But as noted in the introduction, the board has a significant responsibility that is specifically outlined in the Constitution of Virginia. Article 8, Section 2 requires the Board of Education to prescribe standards of quality for public schools in Virginia. And then ultimately, this board's prescription is subsequent to the revisions that may be made only by the General Assembly. So you prescribe and then any changes that would be made from your prescription would be made only by the General Assembly. So that is vested in the Constitution of the Commonwealth. And then the

[04:37:26] SOQs are also found as referenced in the Code of Virginia. Those code citations are listed on this slide and in your packet. And they encompass the requirements that must be met for all public schools and school divisions. And then ultimately, this board is responsible for reviewing the prescriptions to your SOQs every two years in odd years. And so this is 2023. This is an odd year. And that's why we're having this conversation. And ultimately, board, you pride yourself in doing your work transparently and in the view of the public. So ultimately, everything will be done in this setting where you have the opportunity to hear feedback from

[04:38:01] residents across the commonwealth on this extremely important topic so this is a specific reference to the constitutional authority and again some of the key elements of your constitutional authority is that you prescribe from time to time the standards of quality again subject to revision only by the general assembly and there's additional detail that is referenced there just wanted to provide that specific citation for you as a matter of reference for you and for the public as well. And then here is the reference to the Code of Virginia and the Board's role with

[04:38:37] the standards of quality. And again, as you can see, references to odd number years. Exercise your constitutional authority to determine and prescribe the standards, again, subject to revision only by the General Assembly. You have the opportunity to propose amendments to the current standards or determine whether or not you want to leave them alone, but ultimately it is your authority, your decision, what you want to do to prescribe these standards for consideration in future dr meyers thank you good afternoon so the survey let's talk a little bit about that

[04:39:10] that we sent out the uh survey went out to all superintendents 55 or 72 divisions submitted a response you can see the list of the divisions that submitted a response what we did in the survey is we asked them to rank areas from the prescriptions that were given in 2019 and these were all areas that were either unfunded or um or not fully funded and so we asked them what was most important to them today that still existed from 2019 and what we did is we ended up um

[04:39:50] giving them a score and uh with that score i feel like i missed a uh the methodology here it's not there um so just to tell you we created a score for each one um based on we gave a number of points based on how many answered a particular prescription as their number one choice, number two choice, three choice, and so forth. So what we came up with or what we found in this survey is that the reading specialist assistant principals enhanced at-risk add-on in school counselors, K-12 class size reduction made up the top five areas that they still have

[04:40:28] um the most uh concern or the most the the area that they would like to see addressed from the 2019 prescriptions just a clarifying question i promise miss olden just so i understand these are 2023 survey responses to what they think about the 2019 recommended correct that that we're still they see as either unfunded or yeah yep and that's a that's a really good distinction this is data we just got in 2023 about 2019. Very helpful to understand. Now I wanted to take you through just

[04:41:06] for a moment about some of the survey questions that we asked for the 2023 survey and the prescriptions that we're looking at recommending or potentially going forward with. And the first two questions dealt with work-based learning and math. There is, I think, a desire for clarification around what work-based learning and what effective work-based learning work that that learning that takes place outside of the classroom doing real life real world tasks through jobs then math as you know there are new math standards and I think school divisions are clamoring for

[04:41:45] high quality math resources to be able to meet rigorous standards in math assessment and teacher licensure were also two areas um that that we put for them to be able to respond to in the survey and uh assessment obviously with house bill 585 uh and really having high quality assessments and and data that come from that uh to be able to inform instructional decisions so that that was commonly uh we looked at that and then teacher licensure um pathways pathways pathways

[04:42:21] that's what we keep hearing a lot about. And then there are a couple other questions. Whoops, sorry, that went too far. Attendance funding. So as you know, we've had a lot of conversation around attendance, and I think having the appropriate staff and support to be able to work with students and the attendance issues that exist. And then, of course, the Virginia Literacy act um that should be no surprise either i think there is that just much like math there's a desire for really high quality uh resources that can be used for students in reading and then the last two

[04:42:59] questions had to do with high intensity tutoring um and what uh i think really again how schools have ongoing resources to provide these ongoing tutoring um the ongoing ongoing high dosage tutoring that they're looking for and then the last one should be no surprise as well ai is a big big thing i think so we asked them to rank those and this is what we got out of these questions that we asked for 2023 more current issues and as you can see the top score went to the virginia literacy act followed by teacher licensure math work-based learning etc so i think these are all

[04:43:39] really important but this gives you a sense of how many of them scored these issues either in their top one or in their top three. And out of 72 responses, I think the first three in particular are very telling as to what these school divisions were requesting at this time.

[04:44:01] For the responses, the Virginia Literacy Act, 32% said that the funding was their primary issue. After that, for teacher licensure, 76% said they needed to, we need these pathways or flexibility, as i said a moment ago 55 of the responses uh that were about math said that professional development was at the top of their list and then we asked for areas that were not included in those prescribed questions that we gave earlier and mental health class size people teacher

[04:44:37] ratios um 22 said included staffing around that so these were more open-ended questions that we asked that we pulled the common themes out of to run that data to to analyze it and see how that that panned out so the summary of needs as you can see um in 2019 if you're looking back on those prescriptions back four years ago uh those were the top four uh including reading specialist assistant principals at-risk add-on and school counselors and then the emerging needs now you You can see Virginia Literacy Act, teacher licensure, math standards, and work-based learning.

[04:45:16] So that's really what we found in comparing the past to the present and what is most on our superintendent's minds through this process. I'm going to turn it back over to Dr. Raley to bring us home with some recommendations.

[04:45:32] Thank you, Dr. Myers. So if you think about really what the board is tasked with, you're tasked with prescribing standards that are going to determine the quality of the education that students are receiving in the Commonwealth. Certainly, one of my colleagues has described their standards really as the bedrock of what we do related to public education here in the Commonwealth.

[04:45:52] So you have the superintendent voice in the process, and I expect that you'll receive multiple other voices on this important topic as you deliberate in the coming months. But from a staff standpoint,

we took the survey results, integrated that into our work as a team, and I wanted to share a few recommendations with you from a staff standpoint as you consider what you would like to do moving forward and that's recognizing that the future of workforce development in 2023 and beyond is a lot different than it ever has been and recognizing that there's a need to think differently about the experiences that we're going to provide for students and the opportunities that they're going to have in

[04:46:27] their backpack when they leave high school as they enter the workforce and beyond and we call that diploma plus recognizing that we want students to have more than a high school diploma when they walk across that stage. We want requisite skills that they can have to be effective in the workforce, no matter where they go, what they do. And so we want to be able to expand and enhance those opportunities that students have. Also recognizing that 2019, as described in the data, is a lot different than 2023. And the ecosystem that we operate now in as public educators is a lot different than it ever has been. And so ultimately, ask the board to consider what

[04:47:06] standards of quality may look like and how we incorporate the needs of students from a mental health and trauma-informed standpoint. Recognizing the needs of students and youth and adolescents is a lot different now than it ever has been. And recognizing the importance of our students with disabilities and what we can do to provide stronger support for the students that we serve with disabilities and recognizing that inclusion certainly is a significant part of providing education for students with disabilities with their non-disabled peers. And then this board has showing great leadership and leading forward work related to sols standards assessment and

[04:47:44] accountability you're on the leading edge of that and certainly recommend that you continue on that path as you develop standards that are going to be aligned with best-in-class practices moving forward but can um i just want to add make some comments two elements to the video your recommendations yeah so as you guys talked about um accountability and you really looked at the pieces of the pie you talked a lot about post-secondary and really leaning into post-secondary one thing that superintendents have told us is they want to make sure they have the funding to do that and how do i have the funding in rural areas to make sure i do that and they've really had a lot

[04:48:20] of conversation about that and then the second bullet that apostrophe should not be my recommendation it was the recommendation from dave's data that says superintendents so all of this i just want to clarify that that is all the superintendents in the state in their open-ended responses talked about mental health i certainly support them but that is not just my recommendation that was a recommendation from all the superintendents thank you dr goons so what are the next steps ultimately this is significant work this is a heavy lift but a work that's going to set the stage for any sort

[04:48:59] of future recommendation to the general assembly for their consideration and ultimately this is an opportunity today for conversation and dialogue sharing perspective from your position as a board member and what you feel should be considered moving forward in that prescription there'll be opportunities today like i said but also individual conversations that may be had along the lines and ultimately working now and through november to to create what this prescription may look like you'll have a work session opportunity in november and ultimately seek to finalize your recommendations and your prescriptions prior to the new general assembly session so the timing is

[04:49:38] right for us to have some in-depth conversations staff is fully prepared to support you in that work and happy to answer any questions that you may have so dr rayleigh i think what what i would like to

do is if we could just go to that previous slide and and kind of work off of this as part of our discussion that would be really good okay comments sultan questions thank you this is very helpful i think this survey is really terrific um and as i appreciate dr meyer's clarification that

[04:50:16] what's labeled 29 2019 really means 2023 reaffirmation of those pieces of 2019 um of the 20 what's listed as 2019 surveys we those i understand are all connected to specific funding recommendations that are in the prescriptions that the board has previously adopted turning to the doe recommendations on this page and some of the pieces on the emerging needs list it's i'm

[04:50:52] struggling to translate them into funding recommendations and you know some of the things so for instance continue standards assessment and accountability work i think there's no question but that this board is going to do that and that for instance i think would be a great thing to put in our comprehensive plan and it might ultimately affect the standards but the urgency to get a prescription to to work on a prescription to go into our soq prescriptions to the general assembly it may not be urgent on that because there may not be a funding piece attached to it

[04:51:34] or i guess i'll i'll phrase that as a question is there are there ways to translate these doe recommendations into a funding prescription as we have for the 2019 ones i some of them may be obvious so like provide support for student mental health uh well one of our 2019 recommendations that has not yet been fully funded is around school counselors so so maybe that recommendation ties to the funding for counselors but on some of the others is there a funding piece I think that's what we're trying to get out of this. So I think that these recommendations

[04:52:10] are generic and on a more general direction to help drive our conversations of perhaps, for example, providing student support for mental health and trauma-informed care. We have, for several years, had a lot of legislation that's come through the General Assembly that is surrounding additional school counselors, more social workers, more further than just a school counselor, but having more school psychologists. I think there was a bill last year that was a school psychologist in

[04:52:48] every school building to support those things. Are those some opportunities for us to make those suggestions because ultimately the dollars that get assigned to it is the responsibility of the general assembly so do we want one school counselor per 200 kids that's what we are looking to prescribe right but so you're right we don't necessarily have to put the dollar sign to it but we have to be specific about the staffing recommendation that then fun so for instance

[04:53:19] our prior recommendation said school counselors should be mandated at 1 to 250 i think so so has the department got it and then that and that could be dr rayley or dr meyers or dr coons or some you know help us translate these recommendations into something that would look like our counselor recommendation for 20 uh from 2019 and and taking into account what's already been funded from that

[04:53:50] I think our charge last month was to find things that we wanted to bring for you to discuss so that then we can take from your discussion prescriptions and build those out. So our intent and directive was not to bring prescriptions because that's not our role. That's the role of the board is to hear the discussion and then take your recommendations and move forward after that.

[04:54:11] So your thinking is that out of this discussion, you will help us translate that into something that we would then have in November that would say. are more than happy to do that that is on the next step recommendations is for us to take that jeremy do you want to but then i would say still i feel like we

need some guidance from you all i mean for instance on the counselor one it has what the general assembly done already met you all would know better than we it appears that's not so because the the superintendents asked for more support in their survey well but that may or may not be taking into account you know the budget

[04:54:49] just happened in September, for instance, Ms. Ashton. Thanks. What it I might have two part question, but one would I really would love to hear the like, what's the next steps on this? And that would inform my comments.

[04:55:05] Go ahead. Our directive was to bring the survey results and bring recommendations from the staff. What you have here are things for discussion. What we hope to gain from the board is direction on what you want us to do between now and using the weekly notifications, providing resources and then coming back in November and having an extended work session that gets to a set of prescriptions that the board is happy with great thank you so the expectation is thank you is the expectation that we're supposed to finalize it sorry in November or is it possible

[04:55:41] that we could finish it in December I've always we've usually done it in November but we don't usually have a December meeting we're here at the will of the board but I think there's a legislative requirement that we make? Is there a deadline in the legislation for when we're supposed to get it done? We're going to work as fast as we can because teachers and leaders need us to do it. I think that's probably the right answer, but then it's probably some law that says something that we're supposed to do. So, I mean, I was tracking everything you said up there. I have my own

[04:56:17] list. Oh, then there's a slide that has that exact summary. But, you know, I think I really appreciate the priorities um the context is so different so 2019 pre-pandemic 2023 post-pandemic all of those recommendations are so consistent with what the data says in terms of where our kids are where our staffs are where our super intense leaders are and you know i think the just going back to the priority buckets I think that the one shift I might add to just frame it and it's the

[04:56:54] idea that if the adults are okay the scholars will be okay and what I mean by that is everything that you put up there I would put all of our resources in our people meaning leaders teachers the talent as folks would say if our adults have the mental health supports then they'll be able to support the kids who have mental health and trauma if everyone was a special education teacher which i'm biased i was a special education teacher but if every teacher had the proper training around special education and it wasn't just the special education teacher's responsibility then

[04:57:33] we would be able to meet all the needs of our special ed scholars and then no one's going to debate standards assessments and accountability because that kind of sets the foundation and ultimately it leads to better life outcomes for our students which is the diploma plus so i just think the framing around investing in our people leads to investing into our scholars but i what i worry about the prescription um quite honestly is it like what if i don't need a school psychologist i need three social workers or i need right now i need five special education teachers like right

[04:58:11] now but because i have two social workers like where is the flexibility for me to be able to meet the needs of my school my school community so so therefore like all the right buckets but how do we make sure leaders and teachers can you know have the flexibility but this i think these are the right buckets spectrum order so i just want to give a big amen on that um i mean this

[04:58:38] I know we're walking on hallowed ground here, you know, because school districts like their, let's see, it's five pages of this. You got to have a one-half-time assistant principal for 600 students, a full-time, if you've got 900 students, you got to have a full-time assistant principal. Librarians, one part-time, 299. I mean, this goes on and on and on for five solid single-space pages of how much everything's prescribed relative to how many kids you have without an ounce of flexibility.

[04:59:07] To my understanding, then school districts, and correct me if I'm wrong, Dr. Coons, then they turn in where they've met these various prescriptions and haven't. I don't know. I mean, I don't know what that does. I mean, this is ridiculous, honestly, and it's why, and it'll probably never happen, but it's why I'm on a crusade for student-based funding and not staffing-based allocations, because staffing-based allocations gives you exactly this problem, where people on the ground have no flexibility if they do need you know five more counselors versus three more blah blah blah and so we're not saying like you know we're gonna we're taking away your people we're taking we're saying you know what we're

[04:59:46] gonna let you if you have if you're promised x amount of feet ftes then you get to slide them around to what you need i mean that's to me is bare minimum of what should what we should be providing for our school leaders and it's the elephant in the room behind all this stuff because we can say we want 50 gazillion other things funded and we're going to prescribe how many are in here, but it goes nowhere if we don't get the money. We all know that. So anyway, I think to go on and add seven more pages of allocations for everything we want is futile. So perhaps we sort of begin this conversation with where we want to end up, right? Like, so if we want to end up in a

[05:00:25] place where our prescriptions are really kind of not so prescriptive, but more giving our school divisions the flexibility to kind of wax and wane where they need to, then I think that that's where we want to sort of set our stage and say, if this is our goal, then how are we using these recommendations that have been provided by superintendents to give them the maximum flexibility um but also give that give the general assembly the direction and what we really want to

[05:01:04] do in our commonwealth and that is give our school divisions those decisions to make and let those decisions rest with the professionals that know those localities and their needs the best miss So I completely agree with the flexibility point, and I would therefore suggest one thing we put in our prescriptions language to the General Assembly this year.

[05:01:33] I don't think we're in a position to prescribe a weighted student based formula in November. it's going to take a lot more study by us and the general assembly but that we include in our recommendations that the commonwealth move toward a weighted student-based formula and begin that consideration process now so that could kind of be recommendation number one and yet i think it is worth i i do think that our prescriptions for instance on counselors have resulted in more money for counselors over time and so i do think they take the counselor

[05:02:12] the individual recommendations seriously um in the capital and are worthy of our consideration and i think two things on flexibility worth understanding one is that while the current funding formula does not um on paper give the divisions for flexibility they in fact do have flexibility because the state funding is so low most divisions a huge portion of their budget is spent on non-soq positions so the soqs say you must have you know i don't know

[05:02:50] one assistant principal per 5 000 students it's not that but but in fact all divisions except the very most broke divisions are funding way more assistant principals than that so those non-soq positions,

and the doctors here on staff can help me if I'm getting this wrong, but as I understand it, the non-SOQ positions, essentially, they have local flexibility as to. The one other piece I would say on flexibility is in the recommendation that was included in

[05:03:26] the 2019 prescription and reaffirmed in 2021, we recommended, as JLARC now does, that the at-risk, enhanced at-risk add-on fund be brought into the SOQ. So basically that's something like 90% of the state funding for public education is in the SOQs, but then there's some add-on formulas that are not actually in the SOQs, which has implications for the divisions. But we recommended that the at-risk add-on money be brought into the SOQs and that the divisions be

[05:04:04] given extra flexibility as to how they spend the at-risk add-on money as long as they're using it on evidence-based things. So if we were to, I actually would recommend that we include that at-risk add-on recommendation, but that we use the JLARC version of it because JLARC has updated it in various ways as to the formula based you know how you calculate um the the add-on the at-risk population so we use the jlark formulation but with our language about extra flexibility

[05:04:39] can i just make one clarification thank you here um the uh i would agree that this is my former superintendent hat that i'm throwing on right now i would agree that um most positions school divisions are over you know they have a lot of money outside of what's provided through soq local dollars that they're providing that isn't always the case with certain positions and certain um like i could name librarians for instance or um certain class sizes and certain grades those types of things school divisions are are having to meet that you know there's if it's two librarians

[05:05:17] after a thousand students they have to have two librarians where they may say we have 1100 students we still only want one librarian so i just wanted to point out that absolutely most of the time that is the case but not all the time the staffing formula is not irrelevant by any means and it does constrain them and therefore i that's why i would agree with your initial thoughts about flexibility dr siebert thank you um again great conversation and i understand we're still in informative stages not really early stages but informative stages of the conversation um and and

[05:05:55] yes i want to just echo what my former colleague shared that indeed there are divisions that exceed most divisions exceed the standards of quality because that's kind of how low the bar is that to actually get things done you've got to do more than that um and when you go beyond that then you do have some some flexibility but really if you're going to innovate it's nice occasionally for the commonwealth to recognize that the minimum is probably higher than it currently is and therefore by funding that minimum you're actually helping free up the local dollars that are really state dollars being subsidized by local power to get some things done so this this is a very important conversation but i would encourage this and i love and i've always advocated flexibility i've

[05:06:32] always advocated local control but i think we need to be tread when you tread lightly with some caveats and safeguards because we have to be mindful that school divisions in the commonwealth of virginia are fiscally dependent on their local governing bodies and and because we are fiscally dependent on our local governing bodies um you know i think nearly all governing bodies are going to be well-intentioned and work good relationships with boards etc but that is not always the case it has not historically always been the case you know we need to be mindful that there that we that

[05:07:04] flexibility cannot become an opportunity uh to for for for localities to start to do other comments in my role as historian can i just say and again the staff will know more and get me fix it if i get

it wrong but all of the recommendations that we put into the 2019 document were based on some

[05:07:39] kind of research and evidence so for instance the at-risk add-on evidence that those needy kids needed more the one that was based on a somewhat different kind of evidence that i think is worth raising up just by way of information is the assistant principals our recommendation for assistant principals was based on the fact that the divisions overwhelming it was not based on evidence that assistant principals um are evidence-based in some fashion um that what people are using assistant principals to do is a little bit of all of the you know discipline special ed

[05:08:16] teacher evaluation a lot of different things but but the need for more assistant principals was you know in my recollection justified by the fact that all the divisions that could afford to We're we're paying for way more assistant principals just than than the SOQs prescribed.

[05:08:36] So the reality on the ground is that the divisions are voting with their dollars that they do, in fact, need these assistant principals. Now, that means if we were if the general assembly were to adopt that prescription, it's not actually going to mean as as Dr.

[05:08:51] Siebert said, it's not actually going to mean more assistant principals. It's going to mean more local dollar flexibility. to reallocate those funds to whatever they think they need, because the state is essentially short changing the assistant principal funds, if I said that right. Did I get that basically right?

[05:09:12] Sir Rotherham, did you have a question or comment? Yeah, but are you guys going to respond to that? That's an accurate description. Yes, yes. All right. So I said, I guess I have two, I have two thoughts and a question. We're about to raise the bar dramatically on accountability and expectations in the state.

[05:09:32] that with some steps we've taken uh with regard to standards we're going to do that uh with what we're going to do on on bifurcating accountability and accreditation upping accountability and i think that is one frame for this that is going to be important we cannot demand more if we don't also support more and so i think that's like the first piece um and we can align our expectations there's a big opportunity for the commonwealth and then the second sort of related i concur with um everything that's been said i think we should we cannot dictate a new finance system through the the SOQs, but I think we can certainly nod at one and that it is probably time to have that conversation. And, you know, there was JLARC and we want to support more there. And this seems like

[05:10:11] an opportunity to push in that direction, hopefully get some alignment. So those are my two comments. And I'm hoping we do get down to some level of specifics here on, okay, if not the at-risk funding, then what? And if the at-risk funding, then what else? That kind of conversation. My last question is on the process. So those are comments. This is the question.

[05:10:31] what are we going to do to solicit other input like who who how does this process work how do parents get input the public i mean people can obviously come to our meetings and um you know at public comment and so forth like what is the process going to look like as we move as we move through as we've heard from the superintendents that was super helpful um what else are we going to do to make sure that we're hearing from a broad range of virginians we're happy to do whatever the board recommends the board recommended for us to survey superintendents and bring that information back so as you guys discuss if there are things you want us to go out and get additional comments additional feedbacks and work with parents those kinds of things just let us know we're happy to

[05:11:09] support whatever you ask us to do it's ashton oh i um i wonder if there i don't know if it's available just any like financial data analysis connected to the last priorities like could we see like how much did we spend on counselors how much did we spend on the the previous things that i think it would be helpful going into setting priorities for for the next sop sqr something

[05:11:41] um the only the only last thing as i am wondering about and it really is just the nod towards innovation computer science artificial intelligence like how we uh maybe ai answers all these questions i don't i'm not sure but how do we make sure that we are continuing to innovate and not just respond to what's here? How do we get out ahead? And how does that fit into the priorities?

[05:12:10] So along those same lines, are we, and Dr. Myers, you're probably the best one suited to answer this question given your role, but are we still in any kind of situation in our more rural divisions that we're having quite a bit of connectivity issues still in terms of access to internet and those things to to to really put forth i mean i want to be as you know we want everybody to be on this level playing field right as far as if we're going to put something forward about um you know computer

[05:12:46] science and ai and those kinds of things i don't want it to be unattainable for any of our divisions so can you give us a little bit we do collect um in our student record collection we collect household internet information so i could give you more precise and exact information on that what i will tell you in general what it has shown the last two or three years is that it has improved there's been a significant effort from the the entire state to move us in the direction to get these rural communities connected but the fact of it is is there's still a good deal of geography

[05:13:22] that makes placing any kind of ground cable into the ground extremely difficult and expensive, and satellite capability has come a long way. There are thousands and thousands sitting up there now, but it's still relatively expensive and it's still hard to get access to, so we're still a ways out.

[05:13:42] I don't have the exact percentage. I do remember at one time seeing that about 20% were not connected still but i would need to confirm that i i want to make it really clear those are not hard numbers that i have um with that but we do collect that yearly now but your point is taken very well because all schools are connected with high high-speed broadband connections so that's not a problem of any resources you're you're you're deploying in schools but it does become a problem when you start to innovate um as ms ashton is saying and trying to do more from home and other

[05:14:17] areas that can be that can be an issue thank you with respect to the public comment one thing you could do usefully for us would be to refresh our recollection as to public comments that we've already received on the soqs and so we did have a session in late july which seems like an eternity ago now but where we had a first uh discussion about the soqs and i'm remembering and pulling up that we got a letter from the fund our schools coalition and i can't tell from the document who exactly all was included in that but i think i remember that it is parents through the pta that

[05:14:55] are part of that it is um i think it's school board association superintendents i'm not sure all who and the spirit of it as i recall that i'm pulling it up but not reading it fast was in support of the jlark recommendations um and then or a number of the two they were responding to jlark in some specific specifics and it is in our documents and we also received one from the vea the virginia education association on behalf of the teachers about that same time again in in response to and mostly in support of jlark but maybe with some different and and maybe you all

[05:15:33] can remind us have we received any others or do you have any information the the fund our schools when i'm sorry to say doesn't say specifically who i i can't find on the document who was who that coalition represents miss holton in our pre-call i asked you to tell us what you needed and we would bring it together we didn't get any information for you so we can go back and get that but we are not prepared to have that for you at this point in time i'm president mr sturdifant in regards to the rural areas that have or don't have internet access um factually

[05:16:11] in most of the counties where I live, many subdivisions can't get access to internet. Many homes can't get a regular hard phone line anymore. So there's still a large number of students that without going to the local library or to school, even if they had a device, they can't get it. So they're still rampant out in rural areas.

[05:16:39] Yeah. And especially when you consider the geographical areas that you're talking about, there's a lot of rural area that may be more sparsely populated than northern Virginia or the Richmond area or the beach, but you're talking large areas. So when I talk a percentage of students, that doesn't tell the whole story when you're talking about the geographical reference of what you're describing. Some of the areas off the main road 58, subdivisions off of that road don't have access. And this is a subdivision of probably what small compared to here, but you may 70 homes a lot of the homes that are around the lake in the virginia north carolina line

[05:17:19] the carriers have not put forth the lines there because of cost and then you're talking hundreds of families so the the convenience of living in a city everyone's connected 5g that's not heard of down in some of these rural pockets that still have dirt roads so we're i mean is this a viable opportunity for us to move forward with to help um to really help in in regards to this connectivity issue to move our students and our schools as far into the future as we can in order to ensure that

[05:17:54] that we're where we need to be yeah i would submit miss creasy that the the prescriptions are aspirational in nature and although this this body doesn't have the ability to fund those you are looking into the future and saying from a from a forward-looking standpoint we feel that these are the important standards that need to be employed and whether that's uh staffing related to computer science or opportunities are available to students you do have the chance to really set the standard moving forward so it is it is a tremendous opportunity i'm sorry dr norther i

[05:18:29] was just going to say um aspirational is is one thing but i think all of us know that you know school districts the general assembly they're going to make trade-offs they're going to make decisions we're not going to get everything that we want and one of the things that i've found helpful is when you talk to and we survey teachers we survey principals at where i work and we give them a trade-off scenario we say like a common question for a parent would be okay you have a choice of placing your child with a moderately effective teacher who has 22 kids or you get guaranteed a highly effective teacher who has 35 kids so in other words now you're pitting together

[05:19:07] your preference for teacher effectiveness and class size, and they got to make the call, right? And so you begin to see when the rubber hits the road and you can't have your, you know, 15 to 1 class size and your highly effective teacher that everybody wants because you got to pay them a little bit more. So I would just submit that as we gather feedback from, you know, the field, then instead of saying like, the sky's the limit, you tell us everything you want, you know, say, okay, here's some things, here 12 things that

we all want to be funded, but we're living the real world. And so can you talk us through these trade-offs here, which you prefer? One way to

[05:19:45] get at that, and I know our data system's not great. I've heard you talk about that before, Dr. Coons, but I do think, and correct me if I'm wrong, that they have to turn in when they don't meet these SOQ prescriptions. So if we can go back in the data and find, okay, here are the districts that most often can't meet this, but they always meet this, then that will give us some indication of where the real need is empirically as opposed to you know just kind of doing these surveys i mean not there's nothing wrong with the surveys but we need some solid data too in terms of uh where they're reporting that the where the lack the lack is dr siebert yes thank you uh

[05:20:23] a great point and i want to talk about what dr norton said earlier um indeed you know divisions aspire to absolutely check all boxes we want to meet so if the smq says you need to have two two librarians and a media specialist in a high school of more than 1,000 students, then that is the absolute desire.

[05:20:42] You just check that box. You do not wanna leave the box unchecked. So I didn't wanna sound really like I was speaking in favor of flexibility. I think that prescriptions take four pills a day by amount, also include recommendations like drink lots of water, have a glass of milk, take without food, et cetera.

[05:20:59] So I think the idea of flexibility is very, very important. I also think that the JLARC report is important. I also think it's too big for the time that we have, but I think there probably are a couple of nuggets there. And these are nuggets. These are not necessarily my recommendations. These are my suggestions for consideration.

[05:21:16] For example, one of the recommendations JLARC study is to eliminate the support staff cap. We talked earlier about the importance of assistant principals and the value of assistant principals. And there is research base for that. Teachers who lead the profession that are actually saying they want more support, they need people who can come in and help them with a disruptive student and solve problems get things done give them meaningful instructional feedback etc assistant principles do that and so i think the support staff cap actually limits the system principles so i think that uh support staff cap is something that jlark has recommended getting rid of and if we're talking about an soq for the future we should look over the 2008 support staff cap that is still a limiting factor

[05:21:54] and i think we're going to be on record saying yeah we probably ought to take the catholic we recommended decades ago before we um before we as part of that the other piece of this i think that there's a really good opportunity um you know in the so we talked earlier about the at-risk funding at-risk funding has is there it's been important and it's absolutely necessary for school divisions with a large number of students and the jailer study was a couple pretty basic recommendations about that um one is that with this update formula we use to determine who's at risk a lot of it is very reliant on you know the way we use to free this lunch applications that we no longer do so that is a piece in the jlark study but the other thing was there not a recommendation but

[05:22:34] i think would be a consideration is jlark suggests that the at-risk funding become an soq perfect now that would be bold and significant but um that that is certainly something that i think we could be should we talk about i just want to mention we're happy to do the data analysis i think one thing that is going to conflate that data analysis is esser dollars so a lot of esser dollars are going to be used to put in funding and put in positions that would not make this pure data from 2019 to today so we're happy to do the data analysis i just want to flag for the board

[05:23:10] that esser has allowed school divisions to put in additional positions and think about different ways of staffing that may not give you a true up number of what they're choosing to do with soq funding Ms. Halton? So this is a question for really looking to staff and Dr. Koons for advice on two different approaches to our SOQ prescriptions. We could do a longer list that's kind of a menu of options to the General Assembly, and/or we could do a shorter list that's sort of our top priorities.

[05:23:46] And to Dr. Northern's point about resources are limited, we know they're not going to be able to, we anticipate they're not going to be able to immediately fund a full long list the structure of the constitutional requirement that we prescribe the soqs and the general assembly then act on them i'm not sure if if we don't put something on the laundry list that they can fund it so one one argument in favor of a longer menu is it gives the general assembly the flexibility to fund one from

[05:24:23] column a and two from column b if we don't put it on the longer list are they constitutionally and this may actually be legal counsel's question but i think one of the reasons we've done the laundry list menu approach in the past is feeling like that gives the general assembly a full range of options from which to work but it doesn't give them the benefit of our priorities so maybe maybe there's a way we can do both maybe we can do a long list and start our three as our top priorities or something like that mr hansen yeah i i do think we um i think it's incumbent upon us to really

[05:25:03] highlight the top three or four priorities for the general assembly and i you know the slide 14 with the emerging needs you know whether it's the the reading and the um however we want to define the literacy act needs whether it's the learning loss recovery and the high dosage tutoring that's with that i think the whole teacher licensure issue of how we better define that and um and again i would like to have a conversation if this is going to be possibly the

[05:25:38] top four of um you know whether for the absenteeism and the um of attendance issues you know come into this and um and special education it's just sometimes feel like it's uh said over here but um i think in many respects it is still a huge issue in getting bigger in terms of the identification of students and um of and where we are and that comes back as well as just you know some of the

[05:26:10] other social emotional learning issues and um so anyway but i would really think it's incumbent on us to try to come up with the top three, four, five, and just so that the funding and everything else can go with it is really targeted towards those things that are in greatest need to address our crisis that we're facing.

[05:26:44] Comments, questions? So are we at the point where we're giving the department guidance on what we want them to bring back to us next month? Yeah, so I think, I do think that we probably do need to come to a little bit of a consensus around, do we want to focus in on specific priorities? So going for a shorter list versus a long list of, my concern with giving them a laundry list is, you know, maybe the one thing

[05:27:16] that's lowest on our priority is what is accomplished. And so I think giving very specific and targeted direction about look we're not going to give you 52 items here we're saying these are really the most critical things that moving forward in the work that this board and that schools feel is most important to them and here is the information that backs up these requests that we're making you know we have sought excuse me sought feedback from our school divisions and

[05:27:52] what is most important to them and together with the board of education we came to these recommendations for you the general assembly to help us together get accomplished i think that that's the way that we need to personally i think we need to give them a shorter list than a longer list and be very targeted in the things that we need for them to to get to from those those few items bill i'd also just like to echo andy's prior comment and i think we should do that but i also

[05:28:27] think we need to still have an open ear to parents and to others in this process i very much appreciate all the work and the superintendent's perspective but um i do feel like it's um i don't want to say i think the more important perspectives are going to be getting more on the voice of the consumer versus uh the voice of the practitioner and they've obviously got to make good music together but it's

[05:29:01] but i think that's really lacking here and i do think even looking at the challenges that we face these last three years of not having appropriate options for families to look to for other solutions we're getting around that a little bit maybe right now with some of the lab schools and some of the outsourced tutoring opportunities but i think we learned a lot of what did work what didn't work with distance learning and online learning and i just i think having that voice is going to

[05:29:36] be really important of where we are going forward and it's all also sitting on top of the you know the 800 pound gorilla in the room and that's the disadvantaged minority student populations that have suffered the deepest challenges here and to where we can come up with you know better options better choices better targeted opportunities for them again whether it's in the absenteeism or the technical education opportunities or again special ed or whatever it might be but i just think we've

[05:30:15] I would recommend we take a very deep look at that as well. And I think make sure we're reaching out to those communities as well. - Sir Rotherham? - Madam President, I just wanna basically endorse the strategy you just laid out. I mean, I worry the long list, it just seems like that's business as usual.

[05:30:32] There's always, everybody's always asking and there's a Christmas tree kind of always on offer. And I just think we have an opportunity to say, look, we're taking leadership here. We are moving forward on a set of reforms that are student focused and are going to be significant. Here are the things that we think are essential to supporting that.

[05:30:52] I think I would have no trouble, and I would suggest the board, we should say this is not an exhaustive list of everything, but like these are the ones that we think, and that we think then ourselves very seriously about what that list is. I just worry, otherwise, it will seem as if we're doing this stuff, and it's just sort of business as usual around the finance and the input side, and I think we have an opportunity to lead on that piece commensurate.

[05:31:17] what we're doing on other stuff and hopefully spark a conversation there that's grounded in this is something different and we need these requests to be taken seriously madam president the list is this list coming from the department of education or is this list going to come from our board individually board members what elected right i guess my view is different um i rely heavily on the board of education the department of education

[05:31:53] they're the experts i'm a board member that needs their input and recommendations and from those recommendations i may not agree with all of them but as a collective board we can vote on them or

make a decision but if the recommendations are coming from us going down to what i consider the experts i much rather have the board department of education who is loaded with specialists

[05:32:25] doctors and the experts to give us their recommendations based on the information you the department of education in contact with all the school divisions i'm not now granted individual school divisions where people can call us individually or send us emails and we can take that but the information is coming from the hub in my opinion of the department of education and i would like for them to give us recommendations based on their base of knowledge and then as a board we can discuss it and then go from there miss holton yeah i agree with that and some of

[05:33:03] this is just a matter of timing but what what the department has told us today if you flip back to the one slide before that uh um um what recommendations that we address for instance to uh mr hanson's point uh special education well if we now tell the department we we we agree with that recommendation that's a priority please come back to us for something to consider in november that would be an soq funding prescription that would help address that and we need you know we

[05:33:39] can tell them we think that's a priority but we don't know whether you know is special ed already fully funded and there's really not something that's needed to go into the staffing formula or is there something that needs to go into the staffing formula that or or otherwise that would relate to that and then they can give us and if so what would that be and like on the counselors the mental health is there a need for more counselors allow the staffing recommendations or is there a need for something else we agree with your recommendation department that we want that mental health is a priority and that's consistent with what the superintendent survey

[05:34:15] said help us translate that into some possibilities for what we might adopt next month so with that perspective i would be comfortable with the notion i'm hearing from others of prioritizing the one thing that would make me more comfortable with prioritizing is if we could ask our legal counsel just to make sure that there's not a problem that if we don't recommend something to the general assembly they can't do it so we want general assembly to have maximum flexibility and maybe we can have our cake and eat it too by recommending priorities but then even

[05:34:49] just having a tagline that says and oh by the way everything else in jlark looks good too in the jlark report you know or you know some sort of broad um thing that would give them the the room to maneuver if as needed dr northern so i'm just going back to 2023 emerging needs on the summary input which is slide 14 let's go back one if you could so i mean this is uh 14 one more oh my gosh

[05:35:26] there you go i mean this is the low-hanging fruit right reading and math please our kids i mean how many times we're going to hear how far behind our kids are in reading and math and what are they asking for reading and math one and three so that's a no-brainer as far as a priority work based learning is another if you ask me a no-brainer we've been talking about these career pathways that we need to develop for kids particularly ones who don't intend to go to college so and teacher licensure i'm not exactly sure what that means we've already made some movement

[05:36:01] in terms of you know trying to help the teacher shortage but i mean when i look at this 2023 list i'm guessing saying most of those things i think of what we've already been talking about particularly one three and four i would agree with one three and four but i would add bills and so how we riddle these down i don't know but and bill's special ed which um and um and as part of one literacy act that might include attention to both tutoring and reading specialists

[05:36:39] and then uh i would also propose that we elevate the um enhanced at-risk add-on the recognizing the needs of our low in uh our lowest income students our neediest students there um and then one more thing is that just a suggestion it may be what what the superintendents are telling us they need on teacher licensure is just more flexibility which we've been giving them right we in many different ways and maybe we've got more ways we can give it but is there a money thing related to that uh that would be appropriate to go into the prescriptions to the general

[05:37:16] assembly. And the one thing that might be appropriate is one of the things on the 2019 list is a prescription for mentors and coaches for early year teachers. That would really be a terrific supplement, for instance, to iTeach. More funding for coaches and mentors for new teachers.

[05:37:41] And it says in the question that they want to create barriers and pathways for new teachers. It doesn't have anything in the question about mentors. That was in the 2019 survey that Dave presented that was on the lower end. Just to be clear, what I'm suggesting is that a prescription around mentors and coaches might help address the teacher pathway issue.

[05:38:07] It might be worth looking at as an option. Dr. Sievert? Yeah, I appreciate this conversation and that we're getting a little bit specificity. As a heads up, Dr. Cronin and our team, I'm going to conclude the question and invite them to maybe help us.

[05:38:25] They've been doing this work for many weeks and months and years now, so they might have some ideas for us. But I want to throw out a couple of potential ideas to be a little more explicit. Again, I really want to come back to the idea of some less, but how we could make the engineers some flexibility.

[05:38:41] I really like some of the things that have been brought up there, but I, I, I think we, I'd like to know with clarity, what is the status of counselors and not just counselors, but the social workers. And even last year, there was a book or something about school psychologists.

[05:38:56] Again, I don't know, I'm not present, I don't need one for school, but I think the ratio might be a little bit me looking at, but you know that we, the board recommended as counselors, the General Assembly has increased counselors. What's the delta there? Have we met it? Are we still shy? What is the delta between what the board recommended previously the General Assembly has done, special school counselors, and kind of that realm of the whole piece.

[05:39:21] related, I'd like to know where we are right now with requirements of the Virginia Literacy Act. The General Assembly, when it adjourned, had put funding in for Virginia Literacy Act implementation. Currently, a chunk of that funding has been moved into the flexible funding.

[05:39:39] And again, I'm a fan of flexibility. But if we move forward, you know, I just want to know what are the ratios we've recommended, what's being funded? Again, is there a difference there and just i'd like to really make sure that again i appreciate the work john someone's been doing and i just want to know how how much we close some of some of those gaps which then brings me to kind of a question you know dr tunes and her team y'all been i was like when people are waist neck deep nose deep in the data and the issues here you probably identify some other low-hanging fruit for us i i like things that they're picked up off the slide deck i'd actually

[05:40:15] think with reading and math that's a great place to invest but as we're kind of muddling here just a wee bit in a constructive way what uh suggestions you all have for us yeah i think that's slide 15.

[05:40:40] yes please um just to clarify the question is big list for priorities um so just a couple things as we've had this conversation i guess i don't know how long it's been i just want to make sure i understood the process um the team surveyed all the superintendents got some information we looked that 1923 they gave us some feedback and then the staff came back with slide 15 could you put

[05:41:09] slap 15 so the i think it is our responsibility to set priorities we cannot have it i think it's wrong to say we have to do all these things and then kind of hope that things happen whether it's flexibility or whether the budget allows it i think our job is to set priorities but the other problem that i have like right now i would love more information but i'm also really clear that more information is not going to help me because i don't have that information lined up to the data

[05:41:48] that says what is working so you could tell me every school has a counselor but right now and this where um mr rotherham started this is all based on moving forward uh moving our accreditation and accountability system to where we are which i'm super excited by but right now we can get all the data but we're not going to be able to link well is that working is having five social workers meaning that kids at risk are learning more we don't have access to that information so my push

[05:42:22] is to not let us get weighed down with wanting to get more and more and more information and instead set some very clear priorities move forward on our accountability system and then as we continue to innovate in the future be able to say our investments paid off here because we can see the data lining up right now it feels like good hunches and we have anecdotal information but if we're really going to move forward they have to happen hand in hand and that comes with priorities so so so let's just let's go through this kind of one by one are there some recommendations here

[05:43:02] of specifics that you all as a team are hearing from superintendents about how we can redesign post-secondary opportunities so while we have an overarching um kind of umbrella idea here what are What are the things that we need to do to build into what are our recommendations going to be in the SOQs around how we do this?

[05:43:28] What are the pieces to that particular puzzle? So same, we kind of go down this list in that way, if that's helpful. Or can we all commit to support of these recommendations so that we can further build out and have staff build out those specific recommendations that would come in here under each one of these four priorities mr rotherham i think the problem is the four like the second and the third bullets i can roughly get what's going to be behind those and what those are

[05:44:05] probably going to look like the first and the fourth ones are extremely broad so i think it would help to drill down like what are those ones actually what what are we actually talking about there there's a lot that can sail into those i think when you look at the first one we're really talking about that conversation around the third piece of the accountability pie you guys talked a lot about post-secondary opportunities dual credit refining dual credit making sure teachers are available to provide concurrent credit making sure that the work-based learning pieces are there how do you build a post-secondary access you talked about some of these places who have internet deserts i would also say that when we go out and talk to region eight they regularly tell

[05:44:45] us they need some work-based learning support and how do we build some of those things up so i think getting concrete around what we believe around work-based learning what we believe around post-secondary dual credit those kinds of things getting really tight on that what school divisions need to meet the expectations that you're pushing for in the accountability model and i do think that oftentimes

when we think about some of our recommendations the the the more we can sort of cross um industry for lack of a better term with other industries that need the things that we need

[05:45:22] so when we talk about opportunities in connectivity um that could be something that is really more broadly addressed it with support from other industries at the same time and so you know that might be something that the general assembly would latch on to a little bit more than you know something that's a little bit um you know broader and less um more more of our industry specific uh while they are looking towards our particular recommendations in the education field i think something like a

[05:45:57] broader hey all industries can can benefit from this too so maybe underneath this particular one you know dr meyers whatever your greatest recommendation would be on that how we best you know get more opportunities and connectivity that's where we want to go there um and i think that the team is is is um competent enough to come up with some real strong direction around where we are going as far as our standards and the assessment accountability work because i do think

[05:46:33] that um our 585 report is likely to give us some opportunities that we can address here under the fourth bullet um and how we move forward there that's kind of a cross uh pollination of of of work that's ongoing and that has been directed by the general assembly to begin with and um so that And does the at-risk funding live under that fourth bullet or where does that live?

[05:47:09] And how are we thinking about that? Because that in the context of both the reduction of federal funds that's coming, the elevation of standards. I just want to remind everyone that these are in addition to the prior page. Not that we took things from the prior page and incorporated them into these.

[05:47:26] So those four and four from the superintendents, these are things we thought would also be good conversation points for today. So the at-risk add-on is under the 2019 number three, not under our recommendations. So those are separate. Okay. So then, I'm sorry, I'm confused.

[05:47:47] So the bidding is essentially this list of eight plus the four new ones. Is that like, how should we be, I'm now confused. The range of options we should start with is these eight plus the four on the substitute. Okay. So that's the bidding. Okay. So there's 12 to whittle down from or add to or combine yeah but and some like literacy act reading specialists those that's one really and uh uh accountability math standards maybe but one one of the things i do think we

[05:48:25] need as to the again as the 2019 ones those all translate into dollar recommendations are already translated into very specific funding recommendations that the superintendents understand because they've all seen that document over and over again the ones on the right hand side and the ones on the superintendent on the staff recommendations page i mean licensure teacher licensure yeah maybe they're just looking for flexibility maybe they're not looking for money on teacher licensure mr hansen not to be a contrarian here but just when i look at the 2019

[05:49:01] needs and these four categories and all the money all the resources that have gone to those all of the ESR monies that came in that helped on these, and then you lay on top of this, the chart that we have of having the largest drop in the country. I just do want to make sure that this is where we put our focus and didn't work out so well. And so I think we've got to be taking a very hard look at, you know, what the most important needs are, where the most resources need to go to help us

[05:49:39] get to where we want to be in the next four years when we're looking at the next chart. but to be clear the things on the left or the things the superintendents say haven't yet been funded to their

satisfaction now they i mean like some of them may have like the counselors when the budget that was just implemented and just signed in september may have improved the counselor ratios i'm not i don't remember but the average add-on recommendation hasn't yet happened i know and so that's not something that's been done that's something that's been recommended for

[05:50:14] many years and that jlark recommends and that's consistent with what i think we all know about the literature about how much extra is needed now some of those divisions have had extra funds during the esser period but not with a whole lot of time for to show outcomes yet so may not just be extra fun but it might also be reprioritizing funds or um so here's what i really would like to

[05:50:47] do um i want for us to leave this conversation today in a place where we have like on slide 15 four main points that we are committed to moving forward with so that staff can fill in the blanks for what we get um in december or are we going to try to do this in november i don't know when we we want to see this again we are happy to bring it to you in november and if you in november want

[05:51:24] us to come back and do a final for december we can work at the will of the board okay sounds good yes please i think it might be helping this exercise to also be looking down the road the next four years so that we got our true north of what we're trying to get to so that the fourth or whatever number we are we're going to pick out so if we're trying to envision what the commonwealth look like four years from now and what we're trying to achieve and you know if there's four areas where we want us to be elevating ourselves to to me that exercise would help us really dig

[05:52:02] down on how we want to get there so one would be close the achievement gap in my mind too would be to um you know stem of the learning loss and those are two different but similar things you know the potential teacher shortage that could even get worse um looking at the demographics one anyway just to me that would be helpful so that we know what our true north is so that we're putting these four pieces in place to get us there uh dr sievert uh yes i'd first like to say i'm very

[05:52:41] glad that we do have the december meeting now because my request would be that we we we'll work on this again in november before we adopt the first review final view whatever approach you want to use i think that would be very very good i think this conversation has been great i like that we're figuring out what like are the entrees um that we're going to focus on i i do want to lift up one one little side dish for the team to think about and that is i was a little surprised that english learners didn't come up in the in the in the list um i think that's probably because english learners are in pockets around the commonwealth not not everywhere so you know if we

[05:53:18] could uh take a little look at that i know jlr talked a little bit about english learners but more importantly there's an english learner work group working right now they're kind of working on workforce is a niche but i think there's a group assembled right now that could maybe provide some light on english learners back then madam president looking at this list are a lot of good things there one thing that's always come up from time to time i keep hearing it cursive writing is cursive writing ever going to be a thing that's going to be pushed for kids to utilize again

[05:53:52] because as we you know signing signing your name everything is print so when we talk about where the ideas are coming from if the ideas come from a board member like myself is not an expert i would say cursive writing um which is has nothing to do with more money for assistant principals or counselors or kids who are in need of trauma is a basic skill set that i think all kids should have but it seems as though it's not done and so from the expert perspective are we just going away from

[05:54:28] cursive writing for our children yes and if that is a yes why um i mean i'll answer it um i think the idea is that kids are learning to type at such a young age and that often the print they a lot of the folks who study this thing feel like that the print is adequate and that kids don't need to know how to print and do cursive if they know how to keyboard so they're teaching them to print now but

[05:55:01] states uh i think there are 32 states now that don't teach cursive wow and the question i have is that a i don't know whether we do in virginia do we i don't think we do i'm not sure though we are currently revising the ela standards so the question i have is if you ask for input that will be my input to reintroduce cursive writing and get that going again because certain kids can't even read cursive and i think that's a tragedy it may be the way the appropriate sorry appropriate

[05:55:36] time to discuss that is part of our so we are in in early 2024 looking at the english language standards and if we put it in the standards then the schools have to teach it and if we don't put it in the standards the schools don't have to teach it it would fit in the soqs if there is some funding implication funding for cursive writing well in other words if there isn't a funding aspect to it, then I don't know that it needs to go in the SOQ recommendations that we make to the

[05:56:09] General Assembly. It seems it's probably better suited for the long-term implications to be a part of ELA standards review. It's not that far off. No, no, no. We'll be doing that in January. Yeah, hold it. There you go. I just want to put it out because I hear the input coming from the bottom up or the top down i'm saying that we're on the floor i'm going to just put it out there that's one of my interests of um when you see across the country it's just not done and if we rely on computers it's like relying on a gps people don't know how to read a map or use a compass

[05:56:47] because you know they just use directions of a computer baseline skills i think is important to always have so can we all agree on these four recommendations to then have staff support moving forward with so i'm sorry can you review what the four are slide 15 and then we will fill in some more specifics based on what number slide is that so yeah i would like 14 would come into the

[05:57:23] specifics that are listed in 15. so i i would like to ask that the staff come back to us with at least some options to consider based on slide this slide plus specifically items one three and four under 23 to 2023 emerging needs and uh the uh item number three under 2019 needs which is the enhanced at-risk ava and did that include yes and that that does give the special end up mr hanson

[05:58:03] and i'm not comfortable with these fours written by any stretch i think it's an okay starting point but i i still as important as mental health is right now whether it fits into the top four of helping us get to the true north of of the outcomes and the learning that we're trying to get it might be it might be embedded in one of them and likewise a special education as much as i'm

[05:58:33] an advocate for it it might be part of a broader approach on of you know the achievement gap or other equity type of issues but i um good start and i appreciate all the work that's gone into it but i'm not comfortable with these four as the foundational four going forward well may i suggest if we if that it's okay for us to give the department five or six or seven now take the 12

[05:59:07] and merge them into four fours expectation that when they come back to us we we may pick and choose so i think for me what i'm seeing here is everything that we do should be focused on student outcomes right and so the four on slide 15 give us very broad direction as to what can we put under these

to go and and move student outcomes to the place we want them to be for example you know i believe that providing more mental health supports to students

[05:59:45] to staff provides better opportunities for in improved student outcomes because underneath that would also be chronic absenteeism to get addressed and other things that we're not even seeing on here that i really do think are going to come under and maybe i'm not asking the board to commit to the exact excuse me the exact wording on slide 15 just the general idea umbrellas of umbrellas that get to the heart of what what these things are what these recommendations look like

[06:00:22] because i do think that you know as as some kind of special education um focus that we do need to to put teacher licensure under there. How are we better preparing all teachers and special ed teachers even more specifically to deal with the very diverse learners that we have across the Commonwealth?

[06:00:47] And so that's sort of where I'm seeing, where my mind is putting all of these pieces together. So what I would like to see is staff to bring us back those. I think Dr. Rayleigh, you know where my mind's going here.

[06:01:02] I do we're happy I mean we certainly have been good listeners today and understand I think the big picture of the board and where you want to go with these and we're happy to coalesce all that in the recommendations for you to react to at your November meeting provides some more specificity to that you know in the past these have been staffing standards as Dr.

[06:01:20] Northern mentioned you know it's x amount of teachers per x amount of students we can play around a little bit with that but take these big buckets bring back specifics about what those look like your consideration certainly happy to look at the current standards to see if they are relevant for the next four years what may need to rise what may need to be revised in the current standards and then potentially provide some additions or refinements uh that would enhance those current uh happy to bring those back for your reaction next month rotherham should we walk just walk through these 12 just to get a sense of board members have strong i mean we've heard a

[06:01:56] couple of different things because i do worry i don't this can be a tricky exercise for the staff it's like go go off and spend 30 days reading our minds and then come back and we'll tell you if you were correct much appreciated yeah so i feel like we should get to a granular if people have like strong enhancements or strong pushback or whatever just you all can start to get a sense of those and if those are concerns we have to address or those are concerns based on misunderstandings and so point i just worry we'll be back here next month and i'll be like oh well we didn't we didn't we didn't mean that kind of counselor um and it would be i just think i worry i worry we're sending you

[06:02:33] guys off with with not quite enough precision i would also like help on what you want us to survey from families and um other stakeholders so it would be really helpful to get tighter on the list of prioritized needs that you want us to research and kind of get you guys have talked about do we have data on this do we have data on what people did for the services this so it would be really helpful not just have some broad but have some more specifics around the kind of data you want us to bring back and the prioritization that you need for us one board member i don't think we i don't think we need to do like field hearings you guys have a lot on your plate but i

[06:03:12] think we have means of gathering information electronically that we have we have several tools at our disposal for that beyond just comments and i would urge you to use those so we can get a sense make sure we should probably talk about this briefly at the meeting tomorrow so people know that this is um on is going to be on offer and then people who want to uh give input can i agree with dale also but you said earlier madam president sorry that um you know this is coming from the superintendents and i i agree with you maybe maybe maybe you i don't know pared

[06:03:47] down a little bit but you have to take their recommendation pretty seriously because they're the ones in addition to parents and community but i i feel comfortable with their recommendations because i think they know their school systems best so i'm going along what you said earlier that we need to listen to the specialists and the people and we are the board but we need to listen to people who i think have a better knowledge about the topic than each of us do collectively um does that make sense what i'm saying yeah mr hanson i agree i just do think though that

[06:04:26] you know it is our job as a board it's the legislature's job to be looking whenever you're passing a law or a bill or a budget it is paying forward we're looking forward to solving the problems of the future and so i i do think and no disrespect superintendent but most of them are in the here and now and just blocking and tackling and trying to survive and so there's going to be maybe and that's why it's got to be maybe the three-legged stool of you know we're none of us are as smart as all of us so it's got to be a you know collective um process of thinking but um and

[06:05:02] just on the data again to maybe the true north of you know i i think some of the things that we need to really be looking at are you know what the student demographics are for the next four years in terms of special ed populations minority populations immigration you know into the state

[06:05:20] If there's changes going on around the commonwealth as well that we need to be aware of, I think even what is the capacity of our teacher colleges and what are they going to be producing, how many special ed teachers are going to be cranked out in the next four years so that we can really make sure we're looking more fulsomely if we've got to fill some gaps of where things are across the board.

[06:05:46] um so i got more data issues for you but comments in addition to helping us figure out how to take these 12 and translate them into some a smaller number of key priorities may we ask the department to come back to us with some suggested language that we might include in a recommendation about considering a weighted student formula that would have more flexibility and and i don't know whether

[06:06:25] there's a agreement on the board that we should be moving in that direction or or is the agreement that we should be considering moving in that direction i i think i'm ready to go we should be moving in that direction um but i would be comfortable should or should consider but i think it would be a useful thing for us to put some language into that effect let's bite it let's bite that piece of the apple and go for it i agree with that and endorsing the you know that j lark brought it up we think this is something virginia should be considering and we're ready to

[06:07:00] do our part and i mean it may mean that we need to start doing some more serious work as a boy because again we are the initiators on soq prescription so it may mean over the next year or two years or whatever maybe that's something that should go in our comprehensive plan priorities that we start working on that so that it's our work will then inform future general assemblies madam president i have notes on that for our future discussion after this i'm strongly in the should i can live with could camp but i

do think it like if it's the will of the board i'd be very happy to see us plant a plant a flag on moving that direction and we fortunately have a superintendent

[06:07:39] it comes from a state that just did a really very impressive overhaul on this um that in the sort of you know hubbub of education diet you know things that people debate it hasn't gotten a lot of attention but it's actually a very sophisticated reform overhaul so brings brings some knowledge to us on on this question i think we're i don't i don't see any dissension in that idea for us to move forward here great so let's go ahead and keep that on our list of of move forward please so i think what what we want to do here is i guess andy you've suggested just going through this list

[06:08:16] and seeing well i'll model two if it's helpful so madam president reading specialist seems like that does go into the we've we've the virginia literacy act didn't exist in 2019 this this level of concern so that seems like a place where and the vla and there's so much evidence that states that are doing better on covet recovery or sort of insulated against covet drops are because they they were strong um uh they were strong on reading uh going into the pandemic that seems to have been like a pretty good um i don't want to use the word vaccination it sounds glib but a pretty

[06:08:51] good inoculation against against some of that and so yeah so we should lean in it seems like that's a place we should absolutely lean in assistant principals i mean i get it there's a shortage um i i would want to see with that though what are we doing i mean we still essentially if we're being honest we treat the assistant principal role it's a little like the priesthood people kind of hear a calling and off they go and um and then if they're good they sort of get if we could think about that in the context of what does an effective human capital pipeline talent management so divisions are really identifying people not just because they sort of opt in or because somebody thinks they're really good and mentioned but the much more systematically um i think that i could

[06:09:31] get behind under teacher licensure i think it needs to be more generally licensure perhaps and then we could kind of morph those things. Is it an educator pipeline? Yeah. And I have one question on that, and then I'll stop. I don't know the data in Virginia well enough, so I can't comment on this, but in a number of states, we're about to pivot from all this concern about teacher shortages to a whole bunch of concern about teacher layoffs. I mean, that's what's coming, and all the articles that are being written this year on shortages are going to be layoff articles this time next year. I don't know if that's the case in Virginia, but I think it would behoove us to look at the data. And so we come at this licensure, like specifically, what are we talking

[06:10:10] about and what is going on? And I don't feel, at least as one board member, like I have a handle on that. I know where we are as a snapshot right now, but I have a handle on those trends. So let me clarify what your ask is. First, VLA educator pipeline, but within the educator pipeline, you're asking the staff to understand the current staffing pattern, how much of that staff might be ESSER funded and be in a shifted pool to filling holes versus a plus minus. Okay.

[06:10:41] To the extent, I mean, obviously, I know I'm asking a little bit to predict the future, which, you know, I will tell you that's going to be blunt data, right? Because, okay, yeah, we can do that. Anything we can tell directionally how this should inform would be helpful. I feel like I'm, at least for me, I feel like I'm flying blind a little bit. Jeremy and I have been talking about that. We can look at that. May I suggest on that point, Ms. Alton, a somewhat simpler version of that is of the prior recommendations about reading

specialists including the governor's ask for reading specialists to support the literacy act that were proposed to the 2023 general assembly

[06:11:21] i think how much of them have been funded in soqs some of them were funded in this flexible one-time it wasn't it wasn't just that it was flexible money it was that it was one-time money so you know of the vla reading specialists and other vla needs how much of it's not already funded in the permanent funding structure i'm all for that with respect i was asking also for that same analysis online too so i i agree with i agree with that blend to meaning assistant and the teacher licensure what are we actually talking about teacher demographics writ large not just the

[06:11:56] reading specialists i'm sorry i wasn't that i wasn't clear on that you're going to keep going Mr. I'm sure others do. I would like to see us plus up the enhanced at-risk add-on short of real finance reform. That seems like a step that we can take and encourage people to take.

[06:12:19] I like counselors, Madam President. Well, the counselor one is a great one to get data on how much of the prior recommendations, which were based on national standards for counselor ratios, How much of them have already been funded? That one may be one that the superintendents may not realize how much they've already got coming to them. I mean, they probably do, but some of that was quite recent, and I don't know when this survey was administered relative to when the budget was signed, etc.

[06:12:50] So, counselors, it would be helpful for us to know how much of the prior recs are actually already in there. the board of education thanks jim um the board of education recommended four positions for a thousand students in 2019 it is funded at three students per our three counselors per thousand students in fy 22. so major progress but not quite there and then the at risk add-on one i would like to suggest that that wouldn't be included in the one we bring back

[06:13:22] more for further consideration but that it be the jlark version of that with flexibility language because jlark gets in dr siebert pointed out uh gets into some technical areas on how you calculate at risk and how you calculate uh some of the underlying data that i thought were very useful even and that and then i think the superintendents and other organizations we've heard from in public comment have supported in in the spirit of those changes and impressive we revisit councils for a moment i understand i understand that um uh yeah there's national standards that people say you

[06:14:01] know one for every 250 and so forth i think when you sort of step back they were like one for every 250 that's like a pretty intense load and i would like us to look at is there a different standard that we should set given both what we need and where we are post-pandemic um i don't know that we have to adhere to what might be considered a best practice that we actually think is not necessarily going to be a best practice and those are heavy we all know this those are heavy loads um and so i'd i'd ask for a little bit on that i assume work-based learning we're going to fold

[06:14:34] under the new recommendation on the next slide cool yeah any other comments dr northern so i think i don't know if it's going to require a page by page kind of redlining of this document but i'm for like getting rid of stuff that we don't think is pertinent anymore like i'm trying to figure

[06:15:07] out like it's fine but why do all kids need to know how to use a defibrillator you know why do all kids know how to have to do how to do there's somewhat there's like a there's a big thing in here where they've got to learn all this stuff and i'm like they don't we really care about that so and i'm looking at all these other things that are related to decisions we're going to make relative to our new assessment and

accountability or whatever call it system so like graduation rates like we may decide they don't need to take a fine arts class no so a lot of stuff that's in

[06:15:43] here i'm worried actually touches decisions we're going to make in the future and we should at least like i don't know that any i mean these this is not great reading but if all of us looked at the SOQs from 2022 like it's a lot you mean the statute the actual code right yeah like um so it's you know 20 how many pages i don't know 20 30 single space pages and it's a lot of stuff in here and so i think we're gonna have to go through it and just redline some stuff and say we don't want to say that because that's gonna really not align to our you know what we plan to do and um you know with

[06:16:21] some of these things so without editorializing too much the general assembly in their vast wisdom yep does this that is their okay that is their prerogative right there okay code is their job and so we could suggest um you know that we eliminate some of those things that that's altogether a logical opportunity for us to take is to say we suggest these things right these parts

[06:16:54] of this code section be repealed but it's not for us to go line by line through okay what maybe this question for alan i mean are all students learning how to work a defibrillator right now alan that just by way of again by way of history there were some folks who were very passionate about that and took that to the General Assembly some years ago. The General Assembly mandated that both all teachers and all high school graduates get that training. Now that's been some years since some folks very casually took that to the Assembly. I would argue that generally the General Assembly

[06:17:34] should stay out of our territory sometimes and let us make such calls, but they don't. I'm also seeing we're requiring students to complete one virtual course. I mean, really? We just got through a major pandemic where we say that taking virtual schooling doesn't compare to in-person. Now we're actually mandating that all kids in Virginia take a virtual course.

[06:18:01] the legislature for you i mean that's just a lot language right there look how excited dr siebert is too bad we don't have him in the room i mean i guess i need to figure out you're touching on bills that i've spoken on the same way over the past 10 15 years yes so what are the difference between the so cures we're talking about in chapter 13 too so i because this i'm a newbie You're right. We are talking about recommendations that, if accepted, will go into standard two.

[06:18:34] Some of them may be into standard one, which are the parts of the SOQs that most directly address funding. And you are also right that we generally add and don't subtract. So we could look through and recommend things for subtraction in terms of, and the General Assembly could consider it just like they consider our ad recommendations. I would suggest that in terms of our priorities, that may be less useful to spend our time on because the only way they're going to subtract

[06:19:09] is if they do the flexibility route. The flexibility route is more likely to actually happen someday than for them to line any of those things out of that because flexibility, and Alan may have a different sense on that, but the flexibility piece is a fair argument.

[06:19:26] way and there are advocates for flexibility but there aren't advocates for anti-defibrillators where there are advocates for pro-defibrillators so yeah i get it i think um i'm gonna touch on something there are some examples of flexibility in terms of staffing that could be looked at as models and and the one i'm going to give you maybe is already a little bit for example there was an effort 15 20 years ago now to

say my gosh we need to do better job getting technology at our schools so the general assembly uh invoked instructional technology resource teachers at a pretty generous

[06:20:01] staffing ratio and it was a very powerful way to help teachers learn in their classrooms how to use technology well over time that baseline skill of using technology instructionally increased so the flexibility came that the instructional technology resource teacher position could be itrt or in a data analysis piece and it gave us some flexibility the reason that flexibility was good um was because it didn't take any money away uh from from the divisions just gave you choice how to set those positions now some people would make the case that now the data analysis needs and whatnot have grown so much that maybe that's ratios so not good enough maybe we need some more

[06:20:38] itrt that kind of thing so i i didn't think it's prudent as an organization and i would delight i often think that during the general assembly session you know for every new law that goes on books maybe you know every four new laws one should come off so yeah i think that again maybe it doesn't fit in the scope right now but i think it'd be prudent from a governance perspective to show that we are reflecting on what we could take out or recommend be taken out recommend be flexible recommend be something but again we don't want to create a net loss of dollars for divisions we want to create flexibility and so maybe it's a way to look at those positions these are the sets of positions that we recommend but you can you know rearrange them as you need

[06:21:16] locally big job but i do think what we could take out would be a very prudent good governance step any other comments before we matter president are we moving to the next slide are we going to discuss that or we can i mean so my last comment is simply uh you know if we're going to crosswalk counselors with mental health and trauma informed on the other side or not and trauma informs become one of these terms that like a whole lot goes under that and so i would i when you all come back i would like to see some real specificity on what it is we're talking about because people actually

[06:21:56] work in trauma and now there's a lot of stuff being called trauma in education dialogue that's not actually trauma and there's ill effects for that in terms of kids in terms of spreading resources too thin instead of awake what are we actually talking about uh and also with with with mental health to um my colleague uh mr hansen's point like mental the role of schools because there's a lot under mental health going on right now that's very important but what what is our what's the lane we're talking about can you go back to slide 14 please yes ma'am i i have that

[06:22:32] you want bla and reading specialists combined into one what is funded what is reoccurring what needs to be funded educator pipeline enhanced the enhanced at-risk add-on um as a transition to short of funding reform school counselors clarity on mental health trauma informed what those mean some of you talked about work-based learning some of you did not is that going on the the list for us to review or not. I just want to be clear on what you want us to bring to you.

[06:23:00] Yes, work-based learning. Okay, I just want to make sure. Can I give a historical context on that one? In 2019 and 2021, we thought about recommending that a prescription for each high school to have a work-based learning coordinator, and we did not adopt it. We adopted instead a recommendation around regional there were like eight each region getting one workplace

[06:23:31] learning position at the doe level that i think was funded with um perkins money yeah and so we got and i think that i i don't know if those are still there yes still funded by perkins but we went with that instead of the one at each high school i think one at each high school would be great but there were

some arguments pro and con and you know that may be worth having maybe you know it's a conversation some high schools smaller or something i mean i think i think maybe it would

[06:24:02] be um reasonable to say one work-based learning um specialist per division but i don't know that and maybe that was would be too keen on every single high school and maybe it was one per division that we looked at but again then you know some of our divisions are two or three hundred four hundred students can i ask correct and is it only staff it sounds like there are other things like vla you talked a little bit about reading specialists you talked about materials you talked about things like that so with work-based learning as um several of us have been to some national

[06:24:40] conferences recently it's not just a work-based learning coordinator it's the the portals and the systems and things like that that actually tend to be as impactful so do you want us to look at at multiple and multiple spaces in that way or do you yeah okay i just wanted to be i just wanted to clarify because it sounds like the conversation is veering i i would say that i i agree we don't want to look just at staffing but ideally for this purpose we would be looking at things with funding implications rather than think you know if there's things we can do that give departments flexibility we can do that separately from the general assembly but if there's things

[06:25:16] for work-based learning that need funding this would be a great place for us to clarify what does the end product look like like i'm on our site all i see is the general assembly's revisions to the soq's the actual statutory language what is the document that we have to turn in is there an example from last time on our website we ought to be up jim ought to be able to send that to us yes i it may be that it was actually physically part of the annual report rather than a separate document. I don't remember. Separate document, but you can send it to us one

[06:25:52] way or the other, right, Jim? It may already be in that folder that he's put for us. He has a whole SOQ folder for us on the website. Okay, are we reasonably satisfied here with the direction that you all? Okay, wonderful. Oh, on the public comment piece, I do see for today's public comment, I did pull the public comment from 22 letters from this July of 23 and have sent them to Jim and asked him to send them to all of us for today.

[06:26:30] There is a folder that says public comment on soqs, but it's empty. So does that mean we haven't gotten anything or is it not yet been filled out and we can check it again tomorrow? Yeah, we we have staff going back and collecting all the comments that we've received like what you forwarded being we're going to be dropped into that folder.

[06:26:49] So yeah, we were we were trying to get ahead on that one.

[06:26:51] Ellen. Super efficient. Okay, thank you. We are going to take a five minute break and then Mr. Chapman will come with our next presentation. Thank you. Great job. Excited to be revisiting this aspect of the comprehensive plan. At this point in the afternoon, when we did this back in July at the board retreat, my phone was buzzing because the lunch order was coming during the presentation. So I'm at least glad that we don't have that.

[06:35:45] happening right now board members i've provided a copy of the current comprehensive plan a printed, you know, copy, so you have that in front of you. I only printed out pages one through 15 of a 40 or so page plan.

[06:36:03] We didn't know what's missing is from the document you have in front of you is the appendices and that out of an attempt to preserve some of our beautiful Virginia greenery. The the goals of the presentation here are going to follow are going to follow.

[06:36:26] I think the the discussion pattern from the the students of quality that you just had. What we'd love to do is is review the current comprehensive plan and a little bit finer grain detail than what we did in the the July presentation to discuss which of those are statutory components.

[06:36:45] And then to, you know, begin the discussion and real collaborative planning for 24-29, you know, like the standards of quality prescriptions, this is the board's comprehensive plan. This is the roadmap for where you all would like to be going in the direction for the educational system for the next, you know, five-ish years.

[06:37:06] And so this will be, you know, an opportunity to really get this feedback and direction so that staff can get to work on a draft for you in November. we're going to go through each section just observe whether it meets the statutory requirements kind of where it is so you know starting at the the broadest possible level you know the outline of the current comprehensive plan that you'll see in front of you there is a section for the purpose there is an objective of education virginia there's a statement of the board's vision the board's mission two sections that that function together that we'll talk about a little bit called

[06:37:41] the where we are in the background the priorities and goals and the appendancy and so this is you know the high level you know view of what this report is doing but i think the the organization here is important in terms of length it's worth noting that the purpose vision and mission are relatively short sections um and of course the the objective of education virginia where we are in the background are a little bit meatier section so in terms of length those occupy some more time but as as you read through this as as you have i'm sure you'll see the the the strategic weight

[06:38:17] of the document is really in in the priorities and goals and so the purpose of the comprehensive plan um as of right now the board uh you know from the 20 from 2017 when this document was produced um did provide like well here's what the comprehensive plan is supposed to do something beyond just we're required to have one by statute so here it is um you know and try and provide direction for for what it's supposed to be it's this is not a section that's required by statute and where staff could use direction is whether the board would like you know to keep this item as it

[06:38:53] as is gesture toward the sort of edits it would like to see or you know recommend trimming the section the objectives of education in virginia uh this is a section that's required by statute um the the statutory language i believe this is in in uh in the soq says that this this plan shall include the objectives of public education in virginia and so the the current plan um in sort of roundabout ways i've tried to distill what i think these points are saying that the the three

[06:39:30] objectives that are identified are you know maximizing personal development maintaining free government and providing skills for each student to participate in the economic health of the commonwealth the framing of the objectives i think in terms of what the report and what this plan is doing and because this is a statutory component ends up being a fairly important aspect because the board is also required to assess the extent to which these objectives are being met and so you know as you go about considering this particular framing of the objectives of education

[06:40:05] in Virginia, this is going to be very tightly tied to the type of analysis of where you think the school system is and how close is the current structure to meeting these particular goals and objectives. The current comprehensive plan includes a vision for the board. This is not a section that's required by statute. And in the research that I've done, I'm not entirely sure where this language came from other than that it's in this report it's also replicated on the board's website um but again you know the the extent to which you all are comfortable with this

[06:40:45] this particular vision um would like to see revisions staff would be be grateful for the direction the board's mission statement is also included um this section is is not required by statute but the the board's mission um the board's mission does come from the the board's bylaws um So this is this is something that that has been codified very deep into the way that the board is is operates.

[06:41:15] And then the the two sections that the best I can tell again are supposed to function together. One is entitled where we are, which is a summary of the positive metrics.

[06:41:30] You know, in the Commonwealth as of 2017 sites, NAEP data, you know, some of the other things of the time. And then in the background section goes into a number of areas for improvement generically in terms of the large buckets and to try to distill this that discusses resources staffing accountability and accreditation.

[06:41:53] I think this section is supposed to be to meet the statutory requirement for an assessment of the extent to which the objectives named earlier are being achieved. uh and so i've we've included this as an asterisk as as being required by statute um but again some of the the organization um you know depending on the direction provided could be cleaned up to unify those sections a little tighter and then as we've discussed briefly um the the priorities and goals in the current plan you know are listed here this this section again i think can be taken

[06:42:32] to be required by statute. In addition to being the strategic center of the plan, it appears to meet the statutory requirement to include strategies for improving student achievement and then maintaining high levels of student achievement. But, you know, how this ends up being framed, you know, by this board, whether these parties still reflect where this board would like to be moving over the next five years. We have included an example of the types of strategic priorities that the Virginia Department of Education has um you know for for consideration

[06:43:07] um Dr Coons has framed these strategic you know priorities uh and I'll I'll turn this over to her for a second in case this is this is helpful for the board in thinking through its own framing of those priorities so I think as we think about the Department of Education the direction um Bill you said earlier what are our North Star ideas and what do we want to make sure we're accomplishing we've talked in the agency a lot about setting high expectations for every learner and that's about our assessments our standards and our accountability systems and really thinking through that our second north star is ensuring we have a high quality licensed teacher for every

[06:43:47] k-12 learner and really thinking about how we ensure that those educator pipelines are there and they're in a sustainable way third how do we create innovative pathways whether those are pathways in a classroom whether those are pathways in the school some of the post-secondary things we've been talking about or whether those are innovative schools like lab schools or different choices that families should have in their innovation for the children across the commonwealth and making sure we have those and there's not deserts of opportunity and then we need to make sure that our schools are safe and they're

healthy and that includes not only our k-12 schools but our birth to five schools and that we're supporting that safe and healthy environment and most

[06:44:23] importantly our parents should be partners and they should help us guide as our north star what we should we we should see an education so these are our overarching periods of work that we're thinking about in a broader sense and and the priorities of the department and i think in in moving moving forward uh and in reviewing comprehensive plans in other states and some of the place one of the i think a differentiating factor in a number of these plans is is the extent to which the uh strategic goals um the extent to which uh the the kind of framing of priorities is

[06:45:00] also uh you know buffered by by the types of initiatives that would be interested and so again for your girls consideration um you know and maybe some some food for thought in the way that the department has approved approach this under dr coons is in terms of the initiatives um that the department is pursuing uh in order to uh achieve its strategic parties and just as you guys had a conversation during soq's what are the things we need to do now and what are the bigger big enough stars so these are our things now that we have to focus and lean on and then they fit under those

[06:45:34] overarching umbrellas that jim just talked about in the earlier slide the report also includes the what hasn't been provided to you uh um consideration of of our virginia trees um is this list of appendices um the appendices uh include a report card on the board's performance measures um this is not strictly required by statute but may be may be valuable in assessing how the statewide comprehensive plan how those goals have been met which is required by statute

[06:46:09] the assessment of the soqs is the soq summaries those are are required to be part of the annual report but they're also required to be a part of this comprehensive plan so in the same way that will prepare these appendices as part of the the annual report that you'll be discussing um these will also be be part of the conference plan and then there's also an educational technology plan which will be required by statute we will uh you know have have a draft of that um present

[06:46:41] along with the draft of the the comprehensive plan we would sure what happened to our screen but we would we would love your your feedback and i think jim your goal today was to say this is where we are we need a 2024-2029 comprehensive plan correct so we also need guidance we need guidance a lot today from the board but we need guidance on how you want to go about developing a board of education comprehensive plan you talked a lot about student-based weighted funding

[06:47:20] formulas you talked a lot about different things in the soqs around north star how do you want the department to support the board in creating your 2024 to 2029 comprehensive plan comments i'll jump in i just first of all would just encourage us almost to work backwards from the priorities because

[06:47:57] they are just so important and um let's uh if we get those determined some of the rest of it can follow around that and i will say one of the reasons i think it's important is that the priorities as said in the current plan really have been a useful tool to the board over the years in helping us think about policies and lots of other things but we may not have gotten it right every time but we did look to these priorities and so this board it would be wonderful if this board gets greater on what are our top few priorities and then as to what those top priorities might be

[06:48:35] i think we could do a lot worse than to start with the department's strategic plan i mean those are just terrific uh you know the invest if you can take us back to the 2023-24 strategic priorities of the

department slide kevin can you put that back up page slide 10 i think it is the set high expectations ensure a high quality licensed teacher for every k-12 innovative pathways the fast the last one invest in safe and healthy schools well we might need to tinker the

[06:49:13] language a little bit since we the board don't invest that's not we don't we're not we don't have appropriation authority but um and then the empowering parents and the other one i would personally tinker with is the set high expectations we want to set high expectations and then take steps within our authority to support the division and the the department and the divisions in helping every student meet those high expectations so right now it's sort of set high expectations but what are we going to do to get the students to those expectations and i'm not sure what that

[06:49:49] magic language would be we could do worse than to work with what the department has already put forward mr hansen just even echo i really like what you put up here and i think this could even be the starting point for uh the what we had last time of the three priorities is the four i'd always work smithing a little bit i still think closing the achievement gap is probably embedded in the first pillar but um but uh i think this would be a great starting point for us to work

[06:50:21] on this actually could even help us create a thread back to what we just discussed for the previous two hours as well so it should all align yeah mr rotherham yeah i think it's that's all i want to speak to man pros i think it's important that it all connects um and that particularly since we are still for some reason having a debate about whether or not learning loss is actually a real thing and actually happened or how much like i think it's essential that we are forthright in the annual uh report that we're going to talk about later in why we're asking for

[06:51:01] what we're asking for in the soqs which we talked about and in this document so i like this framework too and particularly early learning is a shift this will be important to make sure that's surface and reflected in here um uh but i think like set high expectations i'm not sure do we want to put in something more specific around that like it's it's it's not only set high expectations it's address this enormous problem we have and and find some verbiage to um uh to get at that and that's not a critique of the department's strategic priorities but this plan what the board's doing is a little different i think we want to surface something about you know addressing

[06:51:37] the um you know addressing learning loss addressing damage uh that's been done and something about like just reaffirming the urgency around there because that especially in the window of this plan seems like a pretty core thing maybe a rescue a generation of learners so well one way to address that would be in the um where we are uh the the level setting you know could could reflect on the learning loss and then in your brains um i'm seeing one other work maybe this is wordsmithing but investing in early learning centers one of the things we had before was something about

[06:52:17] successful implementation of the last round of accountability changes here we've adopted the successful implementation of the early childhood education reforms that are underway that's little broader than early learning centers you know all the work regulatory that we do with jenna conway that's really a board should be a board priority that we get that so maybe we can word smith that a little bit to have something about early learning set and we could even put successful

[06:52:52] implementation of vla because that is going to be that is a priority though maybe that comes under the one of the others this increasing please so again just so i'm clear the question is what is the

process that we want to engage in to get to the next strategic plan it's a process person i just want to answer the question that's really my purpose um i guess i'm curious what the other

[06:53:22] processes have been being a new person but the i'm looking at this and i am i am wondering about um what are what are the real goals meaning it is the level setting where the data where it's like can we just like put some data say this is where we are and actually three or four years from now we'd love to see progress we want to we want to see movement that's i don't know if that's bold or if that is not uh reasonable but i keep going back to the mission which says to develop policies

[06:54:00] and provide leadership so i'm wondering what policies we are prioritizing or what policies we are improving that are ultimately going to improve student outcomes and i think these are the right priorities but i think having them connected to real goals would i think move this in the the right direction i mean saying we have an accountability system where we can look at goals and outcomes by student demographics is a huge thing that we're already doing and

[06:54:35] shouldn't be um i'll say we should just gloss over that like that is a policy we are working on it and now how it connects to all of the priorities i think is really important and okay i'm i'm always going to just push us on the innovation side it's like where is virginia leading where where can we like have the data make progress and then continue to lead or to innovate to try new things so that

[06:55:12] we can look back and say okay well we tried that that worked or that didn't work let's try something new so i have a question for everyone but as a challenge do we want these to be more active priorities so we want to be ensuring creating setting because this is something that's going to be ongoing right so that was one of the things that stuck out to me as i read the previous

[06:55:46] comprehensive plan is um we want this to be an ongoing document that we're working towards continually striving to reach these goals of this plan and so i think we need to have them more active and i might say even is advancing safe and healthy schools instead of investing no i'm i mean i'm just saying a different if miss holton suggested a different word than invest

[06:56:21] because of the monetary connotation that it it provides um i i do actually really like these as i was doing my prep i i said gosh this is a really good starting point and i really like it so yeah appreciate it dr sievert i knew you were moving for that um yes thank you very much and there we go um great points and i agree because the department slides 10 11 and i like

[06:56:59] that the comments just been made about those i think they're very very solid very good i also know that there's a lot of things that are required by the code to go into the plan and maybe that's why the current plan is 43 pages my my encouragement to staff as they as they start knitting this together using those great elements on slides 10 and 11 is is be thinking about what is going to be the lean version of this plan i don't mean an executive summary that's still a narrative i mean something that's like a brochure a plan on a page something that that we can actually have at our places as we're doing the work of the board and future board are doing the work

[06:57:34] because too many i just too many comrades plans lack utility because they are too long too verbose and therefore they sit on a shelf or even if it's a digital shelf as a as a adobe pdf document somewhere so i i like the idea that looking at these slides 10 11 we're thinking about the the big picture pieces um i think that you know whatever we do at the end we actually have to have a plan that includes all the code requirements but i also hope that we've to generate a document that has utility again the reason I

looked at this plan is when I was invited to serve on the board and so I thought it was incumbent to look at it and become familiar with

[06:58:14] it but I I I think there's good stuff there I just think that it's current format uh very few people would probably have really looked at it that's a quick question question um the elevate educators in Virginia we I don't I um so right now I could see five years from now we have attendance at this great five years from now it's better it's you know 95 percent of kids are attending school five years from now because of the policies we put out same thing with reading you could say everyone's

[06:58:52] mapping too or something like that i don't how would we know the elevate educators part so let's break apart how this works for the department that first slide we have 14 very specific goals to the action orientation of the department with those those don't apply to the board because the boards as you've said, the board's mission is different than the execution work of the agency. These are our campaigns right now. So these are less of our goals. These are the things we are working on and pushing on right now as elevators. So we have to lean in on attendance to get to those larger

[06:59:28] initiatives and those larger goals. We have to campaign around everybody reading to talk about the Virginia Literacy Act and setting expectations around reading. We have to make sure that our educators feel valued that the level of work they're doing is appreciated and made important to turn the tides on the educator pipeline and making sure that we elevate educators so these are the short-term things we have to be all in Virginia because we have to close those learning gaps that you all have talked so eloquently about these are the short-term needs that will get us to our larger long-term goals so the way in which the agency looks at the way we wanted just to give you

[07:00:07] some thought partnership these are the things we have to do right now to get to the longer term goals you saw on the other slide yeah okay that's helpful thank you ms holton so it's so just to follow up to that these initiatives are all really in one way or another in support of the goals on slide 10. that's right so in terms of priorities slide 10 without students coming to school well you're set high expectations implicitly in set high expectations and help students meet those high expectations so attendant you can't meet those high expectations if you're not in school

[07:00:45] we can't have a great high quality teacher in every classroom unless we're elevating educators and we can't we can't again talk about high expectations and everybody reads relates back to the high expectations but the so i but i do encourage us to think about some language that says because the board we you know we could meet our requirements of setting high expectations and not then be guided by a goal of trying to help students meet them so that to make sure we've got the achievement closing the achievement gap piece in there we need some

[07:01:18] extra verb in that first problem i think dr northern i think what um and maybe i'm just saying the same thing but um i'm a former evaluator so i'm all about like having your outputs and your outcomes align to your goals so like what i'd like to see as a goal would be something like you know dramatically increase the number of students who meet proficiency in reading and math according to x measure right because that's a measurable goal so right now the way

[07:01:54] that these are set up it's a bunch of things that we're going to do but not that we expect in terms of a goal so you know i think for our work i would i would it would be nice if we could get much more um what do they call them smart goals you know measurable i forgot what smart stands for but specific measurable actionable reasonable there we go wow and so yeah i mean something like you know boost

upward mobility so kids who are you know at the bottom decile of um student performance you know move up to the third decile you know what i mean i mean just something

[07:02:29] that's more measurable whether or not that we have the data system in place to measure whether these things ever come reality is obviously a problem um but i'd just like us to you know push us you know and if it's profile of a graduate then it would again be increase the number of students prepared for college career and citizenship like that would be the you know the goal so anyhow it's it's just the verbiage making it more measurable is what i'm after any other comments yeah great

[07:03:06] I'll ask about the the process. I mean we keep going around and around about um subcommittees. You know I mean I think and one thing that's hard right is that you know we have to do all the heavy lifting uh in these meetings and it's really hard to do enough heavy lifting in a forum like this. So I guess I'd just try to figure out what what what it looks like in terms of whether there have been subcommittees in the past and how that works relative to our obligations to be transparent.

[07:03:37] Dr. Chapman, do you want to speak to this committees and what we have done in the past? Sure, I can do my best. Yeah, the the the board is formed in any number of different committees, you know, in in the past in order to tackle separate topics.

[07:03:58] There was a long standing committee, standing committee of the board on schools and accountability. for example, Student Advisory Council, you know, and so so some of those are function in different pieces. Of course, there is a significant lift and timing associated with those, you know, and our timelines are are relatively tight at this point.

[07:04:20] Just because when the when the board forms a committee, those are publicly noticed meetings, you know, and so so there is there is some some logistical considerations to be had. um but yeah the board has certainly shown itself adept um every thursday meeting the board receives an update on the college partnership laboratory school standing committee which mr hanson and mr rotherham serve on that has been an unbelievably active uh standing committee of the board that has generated reams of paperwork does that sound accurate mr hanson um you know

[07:04:56] and and yeah a significant amount um miss holton in my historian role i i think it's my recollect recollection that while we did have a committee on accountability uh and we also and that was actually before my time i think at the time i got here with the kind of committee had reported to the whole we were acting as a board and then we also did have a committee on the soq recommendations that did extensive meeting and work, the 2019 recommendations, but the comprehensive plan

[07:05:35] in 2018, I think was adopted, was worked on by the board as a whole with public input. So we did have a draft that we put out for public feedback. I don't think we, we could check the records.

[07:05:54] I don't remember whether we did public hearings specifically on the comprehensive plan or whether we received public comment as part of our regular meeting procedure. But one way or the other, we should give the public an opportunity for comment on it, and I know we did.

[07:06:11] So given the tight timeline we're working on here, what is your trajectory for us to have this work next month?

[07:06:29] Yes. It's a 2024 plan, so you have time to provide a 2024 plan. It's a five-year plan. so we're pretty much just introducing this today as a we are reintroducing this because in july we didn't get very far

because we had a lot of other things going on we want to remind the board that we still have to do this comprehensive plan um as dr northern said we have a lot going on and we don't want to lose all of the things you know jim's going to talk about the regulatory report

[07:07:07] i'm going to talk about the annual report we just talked about soqs and you also have this comprehensive plan so everything's coming together and it might behoove you to have a conversation about timelining and how you're going to get I mean we can we can definitely do the legwork for you but this is the vision of the board so how do we support you with all of these major initiatives I would say from a directional standpoint that we probably would want to facilitate the use of these priorities and how we then go from there in the narrative capacity that we have to work under

[07:07:44] her in the previous plan so that would be the direction that i would suggest we move in for our next meeting to go ahead and break these or priorities into our narrative piece so for what it's worth to dr's coons point about timing uh this plan the current comprehensive plan technically runs out at the end of 2023 so you know we should get it done expeditiously but ideally we should have started this work months ago and we've been working diligently on many things and

[07:08:19] new board members etc so so we didn't get started earlier the board the staff did get us begin the conversation with us in july but here we are i would just say that in terms of what's most urgent the soq recommendations that go to the general assembly even even though ideally we would have this done first know what our priorities are before we do the soqs in terms of timing the soqs really need to get to the general assembly to be of use before the general assembly meets in january

[07:08:54] and the uh i think the annual report is required to be submitted i thought i remembered in november but it may be this year. So anyway, I would prioritize SOQs, then the annual report. And if this takes us into 2024, as Dr. Kuhn suggests, it wouldn't be the end of the world. That gives enough direction for us to go to the next step. And do you want to continue to doing the annual report, the comprehensive plan in full board sessions and continue to block out time in full

[07:09:32] board sessions for all three? Because you have the annual report, the SOQs, and the comprehensive of plan so do you need time on work session days for the next several months blocked out to get these i think so okay i mean does it actually i'm just trying to really get to the nitty-gritty here one of us or all of us are going to talk through what we want these things to be and then somebody's going to be a typist while we're in a while we're in a meeting and type down what we're saying yeah like how does i still get the process the department really ought to come forward with

[07:10:07] proposed draft for our that has happened in the past regularly that is department listened to our guy i mean i think we should make sure the department understand do we agree with the suggestion that we use slide 10 with some edits suggested here today as our starting point um and that's really five things because the parent piece um but do we we should give the department that kind of clarity today or something different from that, and then they should come back to us.

[07:10:40] I mean, many sections of both the annual report and the comprehensive plan, a lot of the statutory required things, the board never needs to get involved with those at all. I mean, a lot of the appendices, again, they're just mandated reports, which divisions have complied with the SOQ staffing requirements and which, if not, they don't need us to do any of that, but what's happened in the past is we've given them some general guidance. They came back to us with a draft, sent the draft to us, oh, came

back to us with a draft, I think, and then we did talk and wordsmith it, some in the group, and then sent us another draft that many of us sent wordsmithing

[07:11:19] edits back on between meetings and then adopted, something like that. So if we all agree on these four priorities and an additional parent piece so that would be five total priorities then we can give jim the blessing to go forth in his drafting of the specifics underneath those things is that okay or not okay i know that's what we take the blessing i think

[07:11:56] our perspective i'm just making sure you've got the resources either outsourced or in-house to support. I'm going to be transparent. You asked for a lot on SOQs. Dave walked out and said that is going to be a huge lift. This is another huge lift. So we will hit capacity very quickly because there are additional things you're going to ask for in the annual report as well. So we will do our best with what supply we have. I would really request that the board as well, that we really look at aligning these three things so that they are, I don't want to say plug and play because

[07:12:31] a each or different reports for different purposes but there should be a lot of overlap and congruency with this to where and if it means um you know refining the conversation we just had a little bit or sharpen it up um i would be all for that so if we can if we can have more discussion as needed to agree on slide 10 if you can flip us back to slide 10 as the outline of our priorities conversation that me gives us enough guidance on comprehensive plan to inform our work on the soq

[07:13:10] recommendations and the annual report and so if we if we if we either agree on slide 10 as the basis of our priorities or something else you know let's set our our general priorities today best we can and then maybe we could give the department a little leeway to not come back to us with a draft of the comprehensive plan until, say, December or January, God forbid, so that they can then put their energies into the SOQs and the annual report, which I think I'm right, that the annual

[07:13:45] report is required to be filed. December 1st. December 1st, thank you. And the SOQs need to be filed certainly no later than December to inform the General Assembly's work. So in other words, we could give you a buy of at least one month on the next draft of the comprehensive plan, if we all know i mean they all ought to be working in concert but if we have general consensus as to the priorities the actual word drafting of the document and wordsmithing that can all take place later i would go ahead please i would agree with that and i it's unfortunate

[07:14:22] that the timing of what needs to go to the legislature and the you know it's a little backwards i think the plan is kind of the goals that you are talking about and it needs to be the true north that the standards of quality would um go next so i think we'll have to have all of this together so the sequencing might be different but um i think we've got to get this done first because this will i think drive the language and the approach that we're going to be doing in the document of the legislature but when you say first you mean the discussion about priorities

[07:14:58] but not the full drafting right we need to come to agreement here because i think that this will set the template for uh work that we'll just make it so then the question to the group is are these five and with some word suggestions that have been made around are we you know is that kind of where we are or is there something missing or something we want to take out you guys have talked a lot about learning loss so i just want to flag that you've talked a lot about that and a lot about literacy and those i'm just going to flag those two pieces in my notes yeah so perhaps this could

[07:15:37] come those pieces could actually come under some of these one of these headings or high expectations i think you can have the high expectations be um or high expectations to me if we amend high expectations to include not just setting high expectations but lifting kids up lifting kids to meet those expectations that encompasses literacy act and and closing and addressing learning loss um i'm going to play new person what is this plan for meaning i know we're required to

[07:16:16] do it because i just reread the law but what are we going to use it for after we do all the things that we just said what is it going to be used for so besides reporting on yeah i mean my vision of this is an active directional document that provides a basis for the work that this board does for the coming years so i mean i know just like dr siebert said a lot of these documents are created and then shoved on you know thrown in a drawer and never acted on again but it would be my

[07:16:56] deep desire to see that this board uses this document as an active directional north star of where all of our work should stem from this document so then i mean i i would i would prefer to release the pressure of the staff to quickly pull something together unless you guys really want to i'd say let's give ourselves some time to actually do that but we know we've got some big

[07:17:31] things i mean so it isn't there a way to i don't know extend this for a year or at least say the board is gonna you don't have a year or six months or it's when it doesn't say when it has to be done or is it supposed to be january 2024 is supposed to have a new plan i mean i just we can rush and come up with something but then it's just going to be the piece of paper so i think even though from the sorry go ahead first this is of the board i think first quarter of 24 would be um a reasonable time because it is a five-year plan so i think if the work's going into it but i wouldn't want to go

[07:18:08] much past the end of the first quarter but that's april six months or so i don't know i would just not i prefer not to rush into it and i and i'd rather set a real timeline and then it could be a real document and allow us to move the soqs and the standards and the accreditation and yeah but these are perfectly fine i don't have any problem with anything that's up there so it's really about

[07:18:44] what we want it to be and if and strategic plans or should be living so if we want to just pull together and then keep living off it that's fine too i just the way that we're talking about it doesn't feel like we're going to achieve our purpose what you just outlined and feels like we're telling staff hurry up and rush and pull this together while the other things that we've said were our really big priorities are really really important so i'm for it great i think too

[07:19:19] like alan said earlier whenever we do it whenever we get a finished product it shouldn't just be something that school systems have stuck somewhere on a shelf but take the you know the this part or whatever and make it into like he was shown like the pamphlet the brochure he had in his hand to have you know for everybody to see like i don't know like have it some some more tangible as a tool that people are reminded this is what this is what virginia's department education war of education's goals are for virginia's children instead of just it being somewhere

[07:19:55] that they could read online maybe they found it or you know i'm saying like pull that out pull this part out and make it something that is a handier for the average person to be aware of and as part of our regular work we should be identifying that whatever work we are engaging in is part of our strategic priority number whatever so if we are working on x initiative that initiative actually aligns with strategic priority number one yeah dr siebert yeah great great conversation there in

[07:20:33] the room i'm sad i'm not with you all today great great energy and thoughts so i think we can touch on some really important things the code requires a five-year plan that doesn't change it doesn't grant the board from from revising it annually if we so choose so i i would think one way to look at that or maybe some inferior frequency or what i think looking at a living document as this was wisely lifts it up we should think about less is more so i think one way to help the staff i'm there looking down the first quarter of 24 to give them some breathing room i think we could also look at a less is more approach it gets it more usable and actually spell out in it this is our five-year plan but we're going to we're going to revisit it in 18 months or whatever interval

[07:21:13] we decide so that we don't have to try to over engineer we have a strategic plan it should be looking five six years ahead but it should be revised like every two at a minimum so so i think this is a really good piece you have there so with that in mind i think you also touched on the fact that we just asked a lot of the staff for the soq like this should be the priority and the soq is going to have specificity it's going to have that specificity i think that this this comprehensive plan could be bigger yes it's going to have to have the appendices the required required elements the plan itself could be broader and we could say on the outset that this is a five-year plan but

[07:21:49] we're going to revisit it at this interval president creasy okay so sorry to uh dr siebert's point the board is actually required to revisit the conference plan biannually so okay thank you so um that being said we have a meeting um that that we've decided on september september moving backwards y'all December well so um is can we revisit this with maybe a little more skeletal

[07:22:25] uh as you know to try to hone a little bit more so that we're honing this plan a little more every time how do we feel about that fine with me yeah it's fine with me I mean I before we had this conversation I jotted down like what do I really care about what have we been talking about and I I think it mostly aligns with these things, right? It's to Andy's point, it's the less funding, right? That you're going to, like, part of me wants to say, like, hey, big red flashing light

[07:23:00] coming, you're going to lose funding. Like, it's coming. So why don't you start thinking proactively about how you're going to handle this loss? And we're going to, you know, give you flexibility. We keep going back to that word, right? Because we're expecting this of you, and this is what going to give you in return to you know um anticipate what your needs are going to be so i think part of this needs to be us saying to them like this is coming down the pike right like start planning now you know not not a month before all this goes bye-bye um so that was one thing i had in here um and just asking them to start thinking about and developing a plan and

[07:23:38] given the flexibility that we're going to allow and then another one was just um yeah the focus focus on career pathways that work for CT development we've been talking about that's up there already increased rigor and standards assessment systems updates to the Sol that to me comes under high expectations.

[07:23:55] The parent information piece the transparency the user friendly language that we've been talking about that is needs to be the new bucket. And then I would just put I guess it's because my own it's my own interest is attention to widening the pipeline of advanced learners and the diversity of our advanced learners.

[07:24:12] It has to do also with the achievement gap. So I think that can kind of tuck in somewhere as well. And that also addresses this upward mobility thing that I think we need to be thinking about. Like,

you know, a kid's not just stuck in poverty, you know, his or her whole life.

[07:24:29] So anyway, and just I think some of those under those goals is always like math and reading in the short term. get those numbers up have to so that's short term any other comments here no I just I think the timeline like we can't slip anymore so if we're committing to this because I do think it's important to get this out Madam President's important it's a matter of messaging and telling the public what we're doing and so like I like the idea of having reserved space um I'd be comfortable with a more expedited timeline but I'm happy to defer on that but I just don't think it

[07:25:07] can slip uh I don't think it can slip any it can slip anymore all three of these documents are really important to, you know, hopefully try to get some aligned policy making around the challenges we're facing.

[07:25:22] Well, may I just to again to try to give the department a little bit of guidance as to prioritizing for their work. Could we ask them to come back to us with language for the priorities session? But to give them a little leeway on new language for the rest of the report, which is not only these 15 pages, but the 46 appendices, etc.

[07:25:47] Just to give them a little, I think we will find when we dive into the other sections of the report that they're not that complicated. Either we'll use the same language that's been used for decades or we'll come up with something fairly easy.

[07:26:04] Priorities will govern the rest of the work. So maybe we ask them to come back to us with new language to consider for priorities based on our discussion today, but give them a break on all the rest of the sections. - I think that's a good moving forward suggestion.

[07:26:23] - Okay, thank you Mr. Chapman. - Thank you. - I think Dr. Koons is next on our agenda. - Is it annual report? - Yes. So I think we need to take like just, if you just, if we can just relax for a minute, I think we'll be good.

[07:26:49] Suspend for one minute please. - Stretch, please stay in for a second. I'll leave the room.

[07:27:26] Hey, Jim. Are you ready? All right. Everyone has an annual report.

[07:27:41] It's the third leg of the stool we've been talking about. We talked about standards of quality. We've talked about the comprehensive plan. This is really the report of where we are. What the department has done is we have put together everything that is typically in a report.

[07:27:57] But as you guys are thinking about your comprehensive plan and your standards of quality, there are things you're going to want us to report on that may not be in here. You talked a little bit about leaning in the learning loss that may not be in here as strongly as you want. This is what the data typically is at the end of the year. So there are sections that are not complete because we don't have that data in complete form yet. So I'm going to kind of walk you through what is in the report. What would be very helpful for the department is for you to say, and I know you've had this for you to say, I didn't really see enough on learning loss.

[07:28:35] Can you guys bolster the information on learning loss? I didn't really see enough on this space. Could you help us build more of an annual report that shows what that is there? And then hopefully I'll be able to tell you whether or not we have the data systems that can build those pieces for you.

[07:28:50] But I kind of want to walk you through what has been typically in an annual report, get feedback from you around where we need to go and where you want us to bolster information or if there's something in here that you're not particularly akin to. in addition i'm going to flag that this is data this is early data this is an early report it's october this is the year end report so some of the data is incomplete because we are not at the end of the year so you have the executive summary that goes over a lot of the nape a lot of the sol data and a lot of the learning loss at a very high level there is some data around

[07:29:27] staffing shortages but there's also some data around how many students are enrolled we are currently finalizing enrollment data from September count weeks to be able to get that data in an accurate way to talk about enrollment year over year so we will have that part of that data and then you'll see some of the things that we have done in a very high level in the executive summary in the outline we dig into those student achievement results much more deeply we talk a little bit about all in then we move into a pretty decent section on chronic absenteeism

[07:30:03] a section that is pretty significant on the current status the current work on special education to date the current monitoring practices fiscal monitoring dispute resolution processes and there's a pretty deep analysis of what we are currently doing in special education next the report moves to early child care and education and gives you a pretty detailed amount of the current state of childhood early childhood education and then moves to facilities it leans into a lot of the facilities work of the board and where we are with those facilities

[07:30:43] that is the department and the conditions work so i'm going to pause there since you had the opportunity to look at the report and review it were there things while you were looking at and you said i'd really like to see this this wasn't there i'd really like more information here so so that we can make sure this is a comprehensive annual report that supports you, because as Mr. Hanson said, you want this in your comprehensive plan of where we are, and you want this to drive some of your SOQs.

[07:31:16] So there may be things that you want to see bolstered in the annual report to help support those two other areas. Dr. Northern. I'd like to see a little bit more, I mentioned to you over at lunch, about the teaching apprenticeship program, because I think that ties into the shortages that we're having.

[07:31:40] And I think it's a really good program. For those of you don't know, it kind of opens the door for those who are already in the school systems to pursue, you know, licensure and get paid for it. And I think the other thing is just a little bit more around. Hold on. What else do I have down here? Oh, I didn't understand reading for the career and goals of their choice in the executive summary. That's just a little random thing that got me confused. Maybe let me give you the page number. That would help.

[07:32:14] Let's see. They are, let's say, are reading. I'm going to have to point it out to you after I find it. Anyway, it was just a weird phrase. I didn't understand what it meant.

[07:32:35] And then to your point on special education, I think you're saying that the rethinking of some of the special ed policies that you're doing with Nate Levinson and Pizer, no, not Pizer, Dr. Pasternak, are not going to be reflected here yet because it's ongoing.

[07:32:56] It's not going to be reflected yet because I haven't started. We're going to talk about that next. Yes. Okay. Other comments? Dr. Rotherham. Dr. Kansas, this is a great start. Thank you very much. Appreciate it. Appreciate the spirit you're bringing it.

[07:33:11] to us in a couple of places. So up front, it seems to me we can do a lot more on achievement. I know this is not, we don't need to like republish stuff that we've already published, but I feel like, and I said this just a little bit ago and having the comprehensive plan and the SOQs, like again, amazingly, we are still having a debate about whether learning loss is real or some idea that the governor's sort of cooked up and there's tons of federal data. And so I think like we have some state data in here.

[07:33:42] I would urge us to have more graphics, and we've had some that have been shared with us. NAEP data, particularly, again, what's going on with students at Below Basic and so forth. I feel like we have not generally just been very clear on what those numbers look like, that those numbers are a problem.

[07:33:59] Also, other stuff, SAT, AP course taking, I know we have data on that. ACT has college readiness data. think there's just a lot that we can just to set the stage for what we're dealing with and i feel like this is one of these things where you just have to keep communicating because people are busy and and there's a lot of counter programming and misinformation and just get the case out we should also obviously talk about the good things that are happening and what we're doing and what divisions are doing to try to address this it should not be a report so you want the data in some bright it should not be all doom and gloom but it should also but i feel like we tend to over

[07:34:35] index on everything's pretty good rather than like we have and i think a lot of what we're doing doesn't make sense if you're not in the data and as long as people continue to sort of say oh well maybe you know learning loss isn't a big deal i think we have to just keep on that and then finally um and this won't surprise you because we've already talked about it um finance dollars i think we see we need to get into that a little bit again we have to stay in our lane but i think there's things we can do to that lay the groundwork that with increased uh um you know we're increasing uh what we're asking of the schools we need to increase how we're supporting them and i think there's ways we get at that in here without without getting out of our lane or a place where we don't

[07:35:15] have jurisdiction okay okay yeah um i'm sorry that's that's great sister oh yes that's increasing okay um i i agree and i am i'm wondering about the attendance data over time if there's like the average attendance and there's i think it is actually really helpful for people to see like a couple years pre-pandemic to like here's where we are in the maybe post-pandemic to now so just that over time um particularly also reading uh like um mr rotherham's point around just reading

[07:35:52] nape over time i think if people see the trajectory then they'll have a bigger picture of quite honestly how hard the work is going forward and then i i definitely agree on i call more of the bright spots there's so many things that we're doing it's being able to say like even if we just started this initiative or you know everything that we're doing around the teacher work you said like letting our teachers know that we see you doing the the great work i think is um particularly

[07:36:25] important okay yeah your comments falton uh as to finance so well first confession this i since this came out on sunday afternoon i have been otherwise occupied so i have not read this with anything like i'm really reading fast as we go um that said somebody commented maybe it was dr northern about finance in if if we haven't already addressed the jlark recommendations i think it is at least worth

[07:36:59] referencing the jlark recommendations and the general assembly creation of a legislative task force to look at jlark and just essentially incorporate not necessarily endorse all of it but incorporate a reference to those documents i would i would like to ask the board if that's of interest since that this is the

annual report of the board and and if i can just do my second comment and then i'll come back to it then i'll yield but the second would be uh for those of us who haven't had full opportunity to study this one thing we've done in the past is if we can submit

[07:37:37] sometimes it's just a little wording typo kind of things but can we submit feedback to you by email our intent is to get this early draft to you then in november get you a copy draft that you can then between first and final do some wordsmithing but i don't think this is ready for wordsmithing okay but if we have if we have thoughts in response to this after i get to read it tonight or tomorrow we can still email them to you thanks so um if miss holton could you provide a little

[07:38:10] bit more background as to what your why you think that some of the jlark information has a place in the annual report because i think dr northern suggested that the document addressed school finance that we address some school finance and that we acknowledge that the jlark has came out with a major report and findings this in july of 2023 uh with recommendations and that we

[07:38:49] encourage um the public to review and consider them so i if if i were to put anything about significantly about funding pieces in this report i think i would be addressing things around um you know we know that once esser money goes away we're gonna have problems and i hate that to be a a doom and gloom scenario, but that's just a fact that we all need to face. And I would say that

[07:39:22] that is perfectly aligned with, you know, it gives a warning, if nothing else, that we've got, we're going to have to come with some bigger things because we are going to be faced with some complications maybe in the future. But maybe that's got a place here for the funding piece.

[07:39:44] that's what we want to talk about as far as school funding i think just a little context i mean jay lark pointed out some some yeah i think people i think there's probably lively disagreement about like the recommendations i'm not saying just among this board just around the commonwealth but i think the contextual issues they pointed out are real and yeah i don't think i think it behooves us to talk about that i don't think i think we can do that in a way we're not going to make excuses for John Lund: For low performance not going to make excuses for what's happened and where we are, but like these are this is important context, I think we can I think we can strike a strike balance, and it does seem.

[07:40:20] John Lund: It seems if we're giving an annual report we're going to get this other stuff it seems like relevant context. Mr. Sturdefin. Madam President, I'm thinking we should just leave it separate. Move forward with what the board has given us, which is separate from the J-Lard report.

[07:40:40] That way we can get it done. And Dr. Coons, as mentioned, she's going to give us another version of next month. So if later on we need to add to it, we can. But sometimes by doing these additions, it slows the process down.

[07:40:56] i think they're doing a great job with what they they're presenting to us um as this first draft and um i think we should just continue to move in the direction that we're going leaving it separate one last comment here dr siever don't worry i have two more sections i i i'm not sure i heard everything that's been said i have an audio issue there for a moment but i think my understanding is because this is report for the calendar 2023 which is really

[07:41:34] about school year 22.3 yes this is kind of looking in the rear view mirror and as as looking in the review mirror i think it's kind of like just asserting the past so again while i i think there's lots of uh lots of good conversation on the horizon for us at jlark and whatnot i think that's more on the horizon so we're

talking more about the plan we're talking about the the minimum Brian Johnson: requirements standard quality about the plan work plan for the board, this is kind of the report on the past year, so again, it might be an acknowledgement, but I think a lot of this is.

[07:42:07] Brian Johnson: rear mirror stuff in the data you're collecting like the context is provided, we certainly have a chance to look at and weigh it on but again just trying to narrow the scope a little bit for you. So the second, the third section is the Board of Education work, we started by highlighting all of the standards of learning work that you have been deeply vested in and working on and the standards that are currently in process.

[07:42:32] For the board over the course of the remainder of the calendar year we put a decent section in the accreditation and accountability revision. And then the college partnership lab schools is probably the section that is least unfinished, because you will be seeing a lot of applications in November and December as we finish out the school year for lab schools and lab school status.

[07:42:53] So is there anything else on the board of education work that you, the major projects that you have worked on? Obviously I was not here for part of that year, but want to make sure that we represent the body of the work that the board has accomplished.

[07:43:14] Yes, I just have a question. Yeah, I'm sorry. Under computer science standards, it says standards will follow protocols recommendation from governor's executive order five. The standards have incorporated clear expectations on appropriate use of AI and so forth.

[07:43:31] So you know that this is a forward-looking document. Those are predictive statements because you haven't seen the computer science standard yet. So we are drafting with just this awkward space. We're drafting for the annual report, but there are spaces where we haven't quite got there yet.

[07:43:49] So we are predicting that that's what you will see in the computer science standards, but you have not actually seen them. Happy to pull computer science standards out if that's the will of the board, but wanted to represent the work that you are undertaking and where we hope it will be in December towards the end of the year.

[07:44:05] So you're seeing, especially in English language arts and computer science standards, some predictive things that we expect based on early feedback. I know that the computer science team under Dr. Sorensen has been out in the field quite a bit, and those are some of the pieces of feedback that they are putting in as predictive components of those two pieces.

[07:44:25] But if it's the will of the board to take those out because you don't feel like you will finish them at the end of the year, we're happy to do that as well. Those are really there as placeholders for conversation. let's see what next month brings. Okay. Yes. Great. Anything else that you all see? And then I want to talk very briefly about the appendices. This is a list of appendices that we are currently putting together. Obviously, this is a lot of end-of-year work, a lot of data collection, and a lot of things that we are currently building. You have asked for some additional

[07:45:02] data reports. Happy to include those, but these are the statutory requirements of reports we are currently working to finalize and get publishable. And those should be a next month's draft as an actual draft. But a lot of these are working documents at this point in time. Any other questions, comments on this? We appreciate this very much. It's good work. We really wanted to get this in front of you early so that we could get your feedback and have plenty of time.

[07:45:35] Obviously, there are several things that are placeholders because we are in process of that and want to make sure that you have the opportunity to tell us whether you want to include that for remainder of the annual report or if you don't want that in there so there's several placeholders but be hopeful to get you a really solid um fine final revise so that you can give us wordsmithing in november for final vote in december good thank you yeah okay ready for item day sure dr kunz is remaining in her place for item b oh yeah where is it lisa had it right there

[07:46:16] okay are you ready we're ready okay well i am excited to talk to you about special education i know we have brought monthly reports to the board around special education and over the summer i talked to you about a lot of the feedback and the comments we had a great working session at the board retreat you guys gave me a lot of things that you were interested in and stepping back i told you that we were going to work with two national experts that could really give us an analysis in the field that we don't have the capacity to do so we did hire bob pasternick

[07:46:53] bob pasternick as a reminder um i don't know if i am an expert on his here we go he is currently in a sort educational services a native of virginia and the honorable rob a robert h pasternick was the former assistant secretary of the office of special education and rehabilitation services at the U.S. Department of Education and was appointed by President Bush and confirmed by the Senate and may have worked for one of the colleagues on the board. So we were very lucky to work with Dr. Pasternak. What Dr. Pasternak did is he really looked at field. He talked to

[07:47:29] families, talked to our advocates, talked to some of our regional service centers, talked to our superintendents about how they were feeling about the supports they were getting with families. And that was his real drive and focus. On the other side of the house, we hired Nathan Levinson, who is well recognized from New Solutions K-12 at looking at state structures. How are state offices organized? Are they organized to support school divisions? What is the interface between the state and the school divisions? Between the two of them, then we have a continuum. So in Nathan

[07:48:07] Levenson's report, we really understood how our offices were supporting school divisions and their structures, their supports, their focal areas. In Dr. Pasternak's report, we really understood how we were getting to families or not getting to families. We had very comprehensive reports that came in last week, finalized those reports, and really digging into those and understanding what our next steps are as an agency because we know and have known that we need to be forward focused and innovate around special education to make sure we're serving our most fragile learners

[07:48:43] and as i talked to you in april this is one of my priorities and very important to me that we are serving all students well so i wanted to make sure that we had a comprehensive look at what was going well and what we needed to improve on they were very complimentary about the expertise we have in our staff and the knowledge base our staff has. They gave us a lot of feedback on how we are supporting school divisions and a lot of feedback on how that is being experienced by families. One of the things that was clear from both of their reports is there's work to be done and we need a task force to do, a little task force work group to really do that. A task force feels

[07:49:20] like a short-term thing and I really would like to have a cross-functioning work group that works with us over a period of time to say these are the most important things that we need to focus on right now and as we're thinking about short-term and long-term goals what do we need to accomplish so really excited that we are going to announce a work group that um madame creasy has to agree to support

we have three or four special education directors three superintendents from across the regions and several partners, including PETC, V-CASE, Parent Family Navigators, and the CSEP

[07:49:58] Regional Center, which really give us a comprehensive work group to help us say, these are the priorities that we need to work on now. These are long-term priorities. These are the things that will be impacting the field in different ways. So we start our meetings on October 30th, and we'll be bringing updates for you because I know it's important to the board to know what's happening. So we're really excited about that. We are also doing a little bit of restructure in our agency to think about some of the recommendations. And one of the recommendations that we heard is that we need to make sure, as you saw on the slide from staff, is that we're

[07:50:33] focusing on inclusion and what is the best set of high quality instructional opportunities that all students have. So we are moving the office under academics and our special education team will work directly with Dr. Marcy Sorensen and work very closely. In addition, we are going to stand up a prioritized monitoring team. And the goal of the prioritized monitoring team is to support those school divisions who seem to be having the most struggles. Those ones when I've come and said, these are a lot of complaints, we're seeing complaints here. We want to make sure that we have a fast, swift moving team that can go out to those school divisions, assess what's going on,

[07:51:12] and then provide really intensive support that prioritize monitoring team will be providing weekly reports to myself and making sure that i can stay on top of how we're supporting those school divisions who need the most support and making sure we're supporting the most fragile needs we're also thinking about how we shape the work because our division of special populations covers a lot of content it covers academics it covers monitoring it covers fiscal monitoring It covers compliance, it covers due process, behavioral health, school counseling, attendance.

[07:51:47] It is a wide swath of content, and we want to make sure that our special ed team, who our reviewers said are very smart, have potential, can really do the work, have the time to do the work. So we're really thinking about how we pull some of those supports off so they can focus and focus under the Office of Academics. So we'll be excited to continue to report to you how we're moving forward with that restructure and really thinking about that prioritized monitoring team, the academics, and the connection between our special education programs, and really thinking about some of those programs that might be best suited in other spots. The other thing that is

[07:52:25] important to me is that we don't talk about change, that we actually provide a roadmap that goes to clear outcomes. So one of the first things that we will ask our work group to work with us on is looking at these priorities and putting together a 2024 roadmap for special education so i'll be looking forward to next year to bringing you that roadmap so you can see what we're focusing on but we really want that roadmap to focus on five areas we want to focus on inclusion we want to focus on high quality instruction for every student we want to focus on parent engagement and making sure our parents are engaged they have the support and they have the utility we talked about standing up the

[07:53:04] office of parent engagement this is another part of that is making sure our parents have adequate support both from a parent engagement but also from an ombudsman office and that we're providing a tremendous amount of support so really excited about some of those parents who will be on our work group really helping us guide us in that direction and then fourth really thinking about prioritize monitoring and support how are we supporting school divisions and sending clear Andrea Hammock:

Intensive support for those school divisions, who need that support and making some significant changes around their work with special education.

[07:53:39] Andrea Hammock: And then, last but not least, we have spent a lot of time on the board talking about post secondary readiness, we have to talk about post secondary readiness for every single student group. Andrea Hammock: And we have to think about how we are preparing our students with special needs to be successful in post secondary so that will be the fifth area of emphasis that we work on on that roadmap.

[07:54:01] And really thinking about which of these recommendations fit into that roadmap for now and help us start to move forward with those five clear areas of focus and which ones do we put in a longer term focus and making sure we are continually improving and supporting our students with special needs and our families who are trying to ensure that they have the best opportunities for their students.

[07:54:24] So I wanted to give that update for you today at a very high level, knowing it's quarter till five, but wanted to kind of give you on horizon what we found, what we need to be doing, starting the work group and thinking about our roadmap and moving forward. So happy to take any questions, feedback on the work.

[07:54:43] I just want to thank you, Dr. Koons. And I just really also, I think the five areas and especially with the parent engagement about the office and the ombudsman is really, I think, going to be incredibly helpful. And I just appreciate your leadership on this and look forward to helping in any way.

[07:55:07] - Thank you. - Thank you. - Appreciate it. - Mr. Rotherham. - Thank you. I mean, this is obviously an area we need to get on top of it. I really appreciate that you are getting on top of it in such a structured way on the five priorities sound great, particularly post-secondary. We do hear a lot about what starts to happen to kids, quickly 'cause that 18 to 21, and what's the transition plan.

[07:55:27] So that's all fantastic. You ran through the groups that are gonna be on the task force. So I may have just misheard. I know you said there were gonna be parent groups. - Yes. - Are we thinking about including actual parents and it's okay it's difficult to capture no parent can capture the experience of but just having that voice not just the advocates the representatives but actually parents we have pizzi we have um tammy burns who's the executive director of pizzi dana yuroborough who runs the family navigator both of those are parents with special needs they have to be in that space to be in those roles but we also have a parent from the arlington parents for education group specifically

[07:56:06] who serves as our parent-parent on the committee, our work group. I think it's anything we can do to make sure we're really getting it as an avenue for input. As we all know, there's a lot of strong feelings and some of which are cross-purpose with one another, but I think it behooves us to be listening to all of that as much as we can.

[07:56:28] And I think that it'll be an important opportunity for us to keep the special education updates item on the board agenda so I can continue to update you on the work of the work group, on the changes on the things that we're doing and the intentional work that we are doing as well. We did have OSEP monitor in the last week of September.

[07:56:45] We did get really good feedback on some of the past findings and expect some good progress with our OSEP monitoring. We do not expect any formal reports per OSEP until the new year. So we didn't

wanna wait for those kinds of recommendations. We wanted to make sure that we could get moving and we could get moving now because we don't want our students to wait.

[07:57:06] - Ms. Ashton. I also want to echo just absolute support of the direction that you are heading, and it is not insignificant to take a bold stance on inclusion. I think that is the right move, having also having special ed come under academics.

[07:57:24] The right move what students with special education need is high quality instruction. So I think all of their priorities say that, they symbolize that. And when you say inclusion, you're not saying that room over there, which means lower standards, lower access.

[07:57:42] So I just want to echo in all my free time, I'm joining your committee. Great. Wonderful. We can have as many people join and work with us as people who have the time. Miss Holton. I'll echo prior comments about thank you for doing this really important work and for bringing Drs. Pat Shernak and Levinson on to help on the high quality instruction. I take it that that includes attracting and retaining and in-service training and free service training.

[07:58:15] All of that fits in under high quality instruction. One of the key components is tiering what we're doing and how we're going about that. Right now, we're doing a whole lot of a lot. And how do we focus in on those areas that are most important and go deeper in those areas? We're clear pieces of feedback. And what it's worth, my feedback would be attracting and retaining high quality teachers and how they get prepared is just crucial. Second question is on, so for board input,

[07:58:51] um doctors Pasternak and Levinson are they in an ongoing role no they were in a short-term contract that ended the end of September to provide a program evaluation specifically to the Department of Education so uh can we get those reports and is there a way for us to provide feedback input to the work group um in an ongoing fashion once we've had a chance to see them I'm certainly happy to take input in our monthly special education updates and Grace is serving as a the board on that committee absolutely um um because we do have i mean we hear about it every

[07:59:31] month i know you and it's very important to serve our students and i know that many of us do have uh thoughts that may be helpful um um on the parent groups i didn't hear you stay the state sea hack and maybe they'll stay separate but the sea hack is the last one so so they are definitely involved as on the group yep and then my final thing is just a suggestion that when you look at the priority monitoring i think that makes sense to look at but that your prior prior prior prioritizing

[08:00:05] monitoring team i can't remember the wording exactly but that you look at not you look at percentages as well as absolute numbers sure yeah absolute numbers will tell you that fairfax is a huge problem but they may have five students out of their 180 000 compared to a much smaller division we absolutely do percentages right now so that's good feedback thank you any other comments thank

[08:00:33] you thank you dr siebert you don't have anything all right thank you very much okay so um yeah a dr coons do you have anything that you would like to say in our concluding remarks

[08:01:05] before we adjourn for the evening i just really appreciate the commitment to the board i had the opportunity to meet with several other state chiefs from around the country and was complimenting all the work we're doing and i was like well i have a great board who is energized and wants to focus on the work so i just want to compliment each of you on how much time you take how serious you take this work and how thoughtful you are and engaged because I think I made some people

[08:01:39] envious at that meeting. So I appreciate each of you. Okay, so we will convene tomorrow at 9 a.m. and we will be adjourned over the evening. Are we noticed for? I'm sure we are. 630 in the back of the company.